

FINAL REPORT
Thirteenth Annual Meeting
of the
General Service Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous
Roosevelt Hotel, New York City
April 24-28, 1963



ISSUED BY ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., SOLE
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Thirteenth Annual Meeting General Service Conference of A.A.

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1963 Conference At A Glance

The five-day Thirteenth General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous — at the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City, April 24-28, was notable in many respects.

It brought together 84 Area Delegates from 50 States, ten Canadian Provinces and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico.

Among other "Advisory Actions," the Conference:

MONTHLY SHARING

Approved a plan to explore the possibility of making General Services increasingly self-supporting by encouraging groups to contribute on the basis of monthly sharing (regular monthly contributions).

GRAPEVINE

Reaffirmed the desirability of having retiring Delegates act as Grapevine Representatives.

SPANISH EDITION

Recommended continuing study of the possibility of publishing "The Grapevine" in Spanish and other languages.

SHARING SESSIONS

Endorsed the plan of conducting Area Committee "Sharing Sessions" in which General Service Representatives (G.S.R.'s) are encouraged to share their experience and knowledge in helping the Fellowship to carry out specific responsibilities of service to alcoholics.

FAMILY GROUPS

Reaffirmed the traditional A.A. policy of cooperation but not affiliation with the Al-Anon Family Groups.

AREA AUTONOMY

Endorsed the action of the Conference Committee on Admissions in recommending that, in an Area where Delegates have been chosen by two A.A. service entities, the Area's representation in the Conference should be deferred until the Area, autonomously, is able to select a single Delegate.

DELEGATES

Approved the optional designation of "Assistant" Delegate or "Alternate" Delegate, as individual Areas may prefer.

TRANSLATIONS

Recommended that G.S.O. continue to make literature translations available, as needed.

LOCAL NEWSLETTERS

Agreed that it would not be practical to list local A.A. newsletters and bulletins in the "World Directory."

THE FELLOWSHIP OF A.A.

Based on reports to G.S.O., Spring, 1963

	Groups	Members
United States	6,600	117,953
Canada	946	13,093
Overseas	1,484	25,377
In Hospitals	476	10,602
In Prisons	564	22,412
Internationalists ..	—	265
Lone Members	—	646
Totals	10,070	189,702

(Including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 300,000.)

NON-A.A. TRUSTEES

Approved the nomination of Dr. Harvey Cruickshank of Toronto, a vice president and general manager of Bell Telephone Company of Canada, as a nonalcoholic Trustee of the General Service Board.

Approved the nomination of the Hon. John M. Murtagh, Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York City, as a non-alcoholic Trustee.

A.A. TRUSTEES

Approved the nomination of the following A.A.s as Trustees of the General Service Board, under the terms of the new six-region plan approved at the 1962 Conference:

Southwest Region — Roy S. (Okla.)

East Central Region — Howard B. (Ohio)

Pacific Region — Jim M. (Calif.)

Also approved the nomination of Gene K., a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc., as a Trustee of the General Service Board.

LONERS

Urged Delegates, where appropriate, to support Loners and encourage them to participate in Conference affairs.

STUDY GUIDES

Asked the G.S.O. to explore the possibility of developing study guides to the textbook, "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."

LITERATURE

Approved preparation of a replacement pamphlet covering A.A.'s relations with correctional institutions.

Requested review of the pamphlet on A.A.'s experience with sedatives and tranquilizers, the objective being to emphasize A.A. concern with unsupervised use of medication, and the responsibility, felt by many members, to share A.A. experience with alcoholics.

G.S.O. CONTACTS

Expressed interest in having G.S.O. Staff members visit the Areas more frequently, if the economic problems involved can be resolved.

OUTSIDE AGENCIES

Approved use of a special statement clarifying the fact that there is no formal relationship between A.A. and religious retreats, or similar meetings for alcoholics.

Reaffirmed advisory actions of previous Conference Delegates approving "cooperation but not affiliation" with other agencies and encouraging Delegates to establish and maintain communication with directors of tax-supported alcoholism agencies.

SPECIAL EDITION

Deferred, for consideration at the 1964 Conference, action on a proposal that the textbook, "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," be printed in a deluxe, pocket-size edition.

QUEBEC DELEGATE

Approved the admission to the Conference, effective in 1964, of a second Delegate from the Province of Quebec, Canada for the specific purpose of serving French-speaking groups in the Province.

OVERSEAS A.A.

Viewed "with favor" possible increased participation by overseas A.A. units in General Service Conferences and recommended that a study of factors involved be made by G.S.O.

THIRD LEGACY

Reaffirmed the value of current suggested Third Legacy procedures for choosing Delegates, Area Committee officers and other General Service personnel.

"A.A.'s INVENTORY"

Heard Bill W., surviving co-founder, encourage the movement to continue to "take its own inventory."

Earlier the Conference had heard a thoughtful and detailed presentation in which three nonalcoholic Trustees, each a recognized professional in a field concerned with alcoholism, reminded the movement that continuing service to alcoholics will be the key factor in determining the Fellowship's future.

INFORMATION EXCHANGE

Confirmed the need for the exchange of information on Intergroup experience and activity through G.S.O.

"AREA DELEGATES ONLY"

As has been customary at General Service Conferences for many years, Area Delegates to the 1963 Conference were given an opportunity to meet by themselves to exchange experience and review proposals that might be presented to the Conference as a whole. Trustees and G.S.O. Staff personnel are always excluded from "A.D.O." sessions.

Mac C. of Saskatchewan, Canada, chaired the meeting. Ruby B., Southeast Texas, was elected chairman for the 1964 meeting.

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

Emphasis Was On Function Rather Than Structure

The "sense of the meeting" at a General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous can normally be expressed in terms of Delegates' major concerns.

In the past some Conferences have appeared preoccupied with the structure of the Fellowship, with problems of financial support or of communication, with high spiritual concepts, or with earthier political concepts.

To many, the sense of the Thirteenth Conference was perhaps expressed best by the Delegate who commented informally that this was a gathering preoccupied with the *function* of A.A. rather than its structure.

Certainly it was true that this was a meeting of men and women who, again and again, demonstrated their interest and enthusiasm for helpful, constructive action. It was a Conference that wanted to get into the ball game, not merely draw up the playing rules and then relax as spectators. It was a Conference that shared experience, rather than talk about sharing; that participated, rather than prescribed participation for others.

Two new phrases expressed the mood of the Conference. "Sharing Sessions" was one. The "Sharing Session" plan based on test operations and not theory alone, seem to offer a way to focus attention on what is actually being done throughout the movement. It involves finding out what service functions really are, what they can accomplish, not what they should be. It recognizes that the structure of General Services is important, but that what goes on inside the structure will

ultimately decide whether or not the structure will survive.

"Taking inventory of the movement" was a second phrase that occurred many times during the five-day meeting. This, too, seemed to reflect the Conference's concern with function. It represented acknowledgement that what we are actually doing, and how well we are doing it, should be reviewed continuously — that we should have the courage to appraise all service functions realistically.

The picture of A.A. that emerged from the Conference was, to a number of Delegates, a portrait of a vital, complex organism — successful in some fields, fallible in others — an organism of many functions, with great and flexible capacity for growth.

The structure of the General Service Conference has been described as a cathedral of the spirit of A.A. Perhaps, in the past, there has been special concern for the architecture of the cathedral — and a special temptation to admire the architecture from the outside.

Delegates to the Thirteenth Conference were certainly appreciative of the labors of their predecessors in building a sound and durable structure. But they seemed particularly aware that a structure has true meaning only in terms of the functions that take place inside. They seemed determined to strengthen the service functions of A.A. — which can only result in the attractiveness of the structure itself as a haven for all alcoholics who seek its shelter today and in years to come.

COMMENTS BY BILL W. AND DR. NORRIS

The General Service Conference structure of Alcoholics Anonymous will stand up under any conceivable strain and adversity because those who work in it are responsible and because "it is a labor of love," Bill W., surviving co-founder of A.A., told Conference members at the opening dinner.

Bill pointed out that the early members soon came to appreciate that it was not enough to provide a service office for the movement in New York, that the office needed a link to the movement as a whole and that the Conference structure was designed to provide that link.

The General Service Office was originally set up to "teach the movement," Bill noted "but the movement actually taught us." The office can never be exempt from accountability to the group conscience in A.A. and it cannot operate in isolation from the movement as a whole, he suggested.

Bill summarized briefly A.A.'s early experience in providing service to alcoholics and described the first realization that "We had to organize the function of service a little bit."

Had no central service function been set up in the early days, Bill suggested, A.A. today might be half its present size, "and with a dubious future."

"We need always maintain blood in the world arteries of our services, the life-giving blood of the spirit," Bill told the Delegates.

Freedom to take responsibility is one of the basic freedoms in human lives, Dr. John L. Norris, nonalcoholic Chairman of the General Service Board of A.A., reminded Delegates at the

closing session of the Conference Sunday morning. Dr. Norris, who joined the Board at the time of the first Conference in 1951, is Medical Director of Eastman Kodak Company and has been actively concerned with problems of alcoholism for many years.

Dr. Norris cited the "law" attributed to Carl Becker of Cornell University: "Since I am free to do as I please, I am responsible for that which I am pleased to do."

Referring to his own work with alcoholic patients, the speaker said that he could recognize the recovery experience in alcoholics when they were able to tell him that they felt free of the compulsion to drink.

It is one of the miracles of A.A. that it enables alcoholics to communicate "by give and take, by fellowship, by sharing a language of love, a language of the heart," Dr. Norris said. When people express themselves in this way, he added, words become less important, "indeed, frequently are an obstruction to communication."

Anger, resentment and fear are real barriers to communication, Dr. Norris pointed out. He said that he had learned early in life as a doctor that, unless he listened and attempted to appreciate a person without making character judgment, a wall developed "which was impossible to cross."

A.A.'s are "indeed fortunate that so much real communication can and does take place at Conferences," the chairman told the Delegates.

'A.A. TAKES ITS INVENTORY'

A special presentation by nonalcoholic Trustees Austin MacCormick, Professor Harrison M. Trice and Dr. Harry Tiebout — "The Fellowship Takes Its Inventory" — turned out to be what some observers called "one of the most significant Conference session of recent years."

The special panel took a hard look at the movement in order to help separate valid criticism from spurious comment.

"It is a good thing I am sure, for Alcoholics Anonymous as a Fellowship to stand off and look at itself with honest and wide-open eyes from time to time, just as A.A. members look at themselves in Step Four and Step Ten," said Austin MacCormick, who chaired the meeting.

Commenting on a recent magazine article which "must have done great damage" by discouraging men and women from coming to A.A., Mr. MacCormick quoted several passages which he termed "rather less than sincerely thoughtful."

Mr. MacCormick also noted "good things one can find in the article." For example, "I still believe that A.A. provides the best possible way, at present, for most alcoholics to get sober and start a new life without alcohol" and "I do not suggest for a moment that a single A.A. quit the Fellowship. On the contrary, I strongly urge sticking with it. To *anyone* who is having trouble with alcohol I say: try A.A. first; it's the answer for most people."

Noting that "God works in many ways his miracles to perform," Dr. Trice said that the article may be of great benefit to A.A. "What the writer has inadvertently done is to strengthen A.A. and so force it to consider real questions, not ritual ones."

Dr. Trice noted that he mentioned these paradoxical things because: "Quite frankly I have been, in a constructive, not a destructive way, and in a less exaggerated way, saying some of these same things to groups of you for years. In short, behind every attack there may well be some poorly articulated truth, but truth nonetheless."

"You do run a grave risk of being identified with not merely a religion, but with specific denominations. And, unless you look cold-bloodedly at your Traditions, history can record you as a temporary off-shoot of the many-sided American religious scene," Dr. Trice warned.

"How can any social movement 'come of age' in any realistic sense when it has been so universally admired — so over-protected from competitive reality?" he asked.

Expressing confidence that A.A. would make the transition to an adult society, Dr. Trice said that he sees A.A. ten years hence as a "vigorous world-wide movement, constantly educating thousands into the possibilities and ways of enjoying sobriety and health. As one of the main therapies, its membership will be widespread and as a bridge over which the suf-

fering alcoholic can go to some kind of effective help, it will be universally acclaimed."

Regarding the article, Dr. Tiebout said that a woman patient with seven years sobriety in A.A. said, "I thought it was all right. It made me think about things which I had seen in A.A. but had never stopped to analyze."

"She began not by criticizing and rejecting the article but by saying it had some merit to it. She knew people in A.A. such as those described. She too had reservations about the way they acted. Next the realization came that she also was once an undutted champion of A.A. only later to appreciate that all wisdom did not lay where she had found it," Dr. Tiebout said.

"A sense of devotion to the organization which freed one from the chains of alcohol is very understandable. Enthusiasm, fervor and a somewhat blind concentration on the group and its offerings simply is to be expected. Most A.A.'s go through a period when they feel they have entered the magic circle and no longer are outsiders," he said.

"As a rule, however, this phase of putting A.A. on a pedestal evaporates," he said. "A.A. is not made of gods but of people who have the frailties and infirmities of the flesh. A.A. is seen more accurately as a working organization carrying a message to drunks, not always doing the job perfectly but with sufficient know-how to help a certain percentage attain sobriety. The sheen is off, but the solid core of service remains. In this way each A.A. comes of age. Each member does what he can and leaves the rest to a Higher Power."

Dr. Tiebout said some individuals often seem to need "something like this article to jar them loose from their rigid ways. They may not welcome the kind of medicine, but they need it."

In the meantime, Dr. Tiebout added, "The rest of A.A. can continue on as before. They are the ones who have moved beyond blind loyalty to a state where they are able to look at the contents of the article objectively and thus profit from the insights contained therein."

As to the consequences of the article on referrals of alcoholics to A.A. Dr. Tiebout noted that A.A. will continue to gain referrals from those in the field who know, firsthand, A.A.'s record of accomplishment. Everyone with experience will regret the one-sidedness of the remarks and will continue to use A.A. as the first line of defense in the treatment of alcoholics.

"A.A. is known not by its advertising, but by its works. Its position in the community life is secure. No article can shake the hold which over twenty-five years of successful service has created. A.A. will still have all it can do and more," Dr. Tiebout said.

BILL COMMENDS INVENTORY-TAKING

The Conference presentation on "The Fellowship Takes Its Inventory" marked a historic moment in the development of Alcoholics Anonymous. Bill W., co-founder of the Society declared in an informal commentary on the session.

The presentation had been inspired by an article, sharply critical of A.A., in Harper's Magazine in January.

Taking inventory is a sign of growth, Bill said, noting that "It may be a mark of a certain degree of maturity on our part that members of the Fellowship seem to have been less disturbed by the critical article than our nonalcoholic friends have been."

"The subjects for a movement inventory are legion," the co-founder pointed out. "The important thing is that the process has begun. I hope that every considerable gathering of A.A.'s will give thought to sessions on taking inventory of A.A. and to inviting critics, even hostile ones, to participate. Because you sometimes find that people animated by what may appear to be the worst possible motives speak truth in large portions."

Noting that we are living in times of great change, Bill

suggested that A.A. members always distinguish between changes proposed in the Fellowship's basic principles and those which related to the means of functioning as a society.

Reviewing other historic moments in A.A. history that represented steps toward maturity and responsibility, Bill pointed out that publication of the Big Book, the establishment of a General Service Office and formation of the Conference itself all constituted changes through which the Fellowship had advanced to higher concepts of practical service to alcoholics.

To be effective, the group conscience of A.A. must be informed on developments affecting the movement, Bill said, and there are times when the Fellowship's "trusted servants" must be relied upon to take the initiative to help A.A. fulfill its primary purpose.

The relationship of trusted servants to the group conscience is hard to define, Bill said. Any definition would have to take into account the "extreme fallibility" of such servants and the spiritual basis of the authority entrusted to the group conscience.

'OUR COMMON WELFARE'

The common welfare of all members of A.A. means that each group shares responsibility for making the recovery program meaningful to old-timers and "middle-timers," as well as newcomers, it was suggested during a special three-part presentation to the 1963 Conference.

Participants were Jo D. of Alabama, Don N. of Alberta, Canada, and Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff member.

Each speaker cited the First Tradition of A.A.: "Our Common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends on A.A. unity."

Sponsorship is the key to making A.A. richer and more meaningful to all members, Don pointed out.

"We hear much today about how we can interest the old-timer or the middle-timer and get them back into active participation in the local group," he said. "To me, this is a case of closing the barn door after the horse is gone. More important than what we do for these people to get them back is what we are doing now for our present members so that tomorrow's old-timer will remain active and interested in A.A."

New members of his home groups are told about G.S.O. early; they are encouraged to be proud of supporting General Service; they are urged to participate in Area conferences or round-ups and they are quickly introduced to The Grapevine via pre-paid subscriptions.

Hazel said that the first really critical period of a member's association with a group seems to come after he has completed

his first service as a group officer and may have become tired of "the same old personal stories." More fortunate members discover, at this point, that there are many challenging service opportunities outside the group, she said. She cited the multiple needs for service in Intergroups, on Area Committees, in work for The Grapevine and in work, as individuals, in the general field of alcoholism.

A.A. groups have a special need for the experience and counsel of middle-timers and old-timers; members, whatever their A.A. longevity, have a need for the group, Hazel said. "If these older members are included in group planning, we won't have to seek them out to speak at Old-Timers Meetings because they will already be with us," she said.

Hazel said it was hoped that the new "Sharing Sessions" described to the Conference will attract new interest to group meetings.

Jo D., in her talk, reported that nine out of ten persons at a recent group meeting she had attended had not agreed that "our common welfare" came before personal recovery. She said she felt this was perhaps due to faulty communication, and failure to appreciate the importance of "a love that comes from a Higher Power" as a fact in the recovery program.

No amount of communication will change situations in A.A., however, "unless we change," Jo said, "and there is no surer way to change than to take inventory and correct our faults."

'NOT COMPROMISE, BUT CERTAINTY'

"The importance of the Conference is never what we do here, but the fact that we are here," Bernard B. Smith reminded the Delegates, recalling his frequently-expressed conviction that all Conferences should seek "not compromise but certainty" when major policy issues are involved.

Mr. Smith, a Trustee for nearly 20 years and a former chairman of the General Service Board, is the attorney who played the leading role in the incorporation of the Board and in drawing up its bylaws. The bylaws are unique among legal instruments of their type in that they reflect the spiritual concepts underlying the Society and its work.

He closed his brief talk by referring to the now-famous passage with which he concluded his address as chairman of the 1954 Conference:

"We owe an obligation to society to insure that this ideal Fellowship which we possess, this flame of faith, this beacon light of hope for the world, ignited by the spirit lamps of your suffering and recovery, must never be extinguished. We may not need a General Service Conference to insure our own recovery; we do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness one short block away from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight destined to alco-

holism. We need it to provide, in keeping with our Twelve Steps, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who, in the ages ahead, can find that rebirth which brought us back to life. We need it because we, more than all others, are conscious of the devastating human urge for power and prestige which we must insure can never invade A.A.

"We need it to insure A.A. against government, while insulating it from anarchy. We need it to protect A.A. against disintegration while preventing over-integration. We need it so that Alcoholics Anonymous, and Alcoholics Anonymous alone, is the ultimate depository of its Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions and all of its services. We need it to insure that changes within A.A. come only as a response to the needs and wants of all of A.A., and not of any few. We need it to insure that the doors of the halls of A.A. never have locks on them, so that all people, of all times, that have an alcoholic problem may enter these halls unasked, and feel welcome. We need it to be sure that Alcoholics Anonymous never asks of anyone who needs us what his or her race is, what his or her creed is, what his or her social position is. We need it because, in the words of Pope Pius XII, we believe 'Every people and every race which has been formed on earth today has an equal right to say, Our Father Who Art In Heaven.'"

Report on Al-Anon

There are today approximately 2,500 Al-Anon Family Groups throughout the world, Lois W., wife of A.A.'s co-founder, reported in a brief talk to 1963 Conference Delegates at the opening dinner. The Family Groups comprise wives, husbands and other close relatives of alcoholics.

The Family Groups have borrowed their basic format and procedures from A.A., Lois said. "We try to do for ourselves what the alcoholic does for himself. Our primary purpose is to live spiritually by Twelve Suggested Steps, to comfort newcomers and to help the alcoholic in our homes."

Lois recalled that the Family Groups developed out of the realization that the mates of alcoholics had to change their attitudes and ways of living if the home of an alcoholic was to be a happy one. The Al-Anon central service office was set up following Bill's travels throughout the country in 1948, she said. Bill had noted the growth of Family Groups and had suggested that they needed a central office, Lois pointed out.

Conference Notes

CONVENTION INVITATION FOR 1970

An invitation to hold an International Convention of A.A. in Boston in 1970 was noted by the Conference. The invitation was in the form of a letter to the General Service Board from the Greater Boston Chamber of Commerce. (There has been no formal discussion of a 1970 Convention to date.) The Delegate from Hawaii also invited the Conference to consider Hawaii as the site for a 1970 gathering.

FINNISH A.A. INMATES GREET PRISON GROUPS HERE

Aarne H., Observer from Finland, read to the Conference a moving letter in which 100 members of three A.A. groups in the Helsinki Central Penitentiary sent greetings to members of institutional groups in the States.

THE CONCEPT OF MONTHLY SHARING

A gradual approach to increased acceptance of the concept of "monthly sharing" (regular monthly contributions) for the support of General Services was suggested during one of the key special presentations of the 1963 Conference.

Delegates who participated included Joe B. (So. Coastal California), Laurence F. (Oklahoma) and Charles C. (Ontario-Western). The presentation was chaired by Tom S., an A.A. Trustee.

Procedures used for helping to finance General Services in various Areas were described to the Conference.

Members in Ontario are asked by the Ontario Committee to contribute not only for World Services, but also for Area services administered by the Committee. In forwarding funds to the Committee, group secretaries can specify how much should be allocated for Provincial services and how much should be relayed to G.S.O. for World Services. If the secretary neglects to specify how funds should be allocated, two-thirds of the group contribution are automatically assigned to G.S.O., with the remaining third being retained in the Province.

Southern California relies heavily on proceeds from an annual three-day Southern California Conference to provide strong support of World Services. The first Conferences a number of years ago were not too successful in generating this support, the Area Delegate noted, pointing out that the Area had improved its financing techniques over the years. To eliminate travel expense, "imported" speakers are no longer featured at the A.A. meetings held at the Conference. A \$1.00 registration fee is charged all participants, replacing the earlier appeal to individual groups for contributions to finance

the meetings. Social events at the gatherings are budgeted carefully with an eye to returning a profit that can be contributed to General Services. Nearly 3,700 people registered for the most recent S. California Conference in San Diego last fall, it was reported.

The Oklahoma Delegate described the success of the so-called Birthday Plan for support of General Services which originated in his Area about 15 years ago. Under this Plan, members contribute \$1.00 per year of sobriety, up to a suggested maximum of \$10.00 on each anniversary of their entrance into A.A. (Some members contribute more.) The Plan has been approved by several General Service Conferences as a supplementary source of financing G.S.O. services and has been adopted in a number of Areas. Thousands of Birthday Plan contribution envelopes have been distributed to groups upon request.

Adoption of a system of "monthly sharing" or regular monthly contributions by groups might make it possible, in time, to eliminate recurring appeals for funds from G.S.O., it was suggested.

Delegates were asked to explore the potential of "some kind of monthly contribution plan" during the next four or five months, utilizing the "Sharing Session" technique described in another section of this Conference Report. If this is done, results could be evaluated by September, with a possibility of a joint meeting of the Trustees' Finance Committee and the Conference Finance Committee in October or November, at which time a test of the plan - if deemed feasible - could be scheduled in specified Areas.

TABLE TOPIC SESSION STUDIES THREE PROBLEMS

One of the best stimulating sessions of the entire Conference divided the Delegates into eleven groups of from seven to eleven persons, with each group being asked to contribute its "best" constructive answer to each of three questions. The answers provided by each group were then displayed on blackboards, for the benefit of the entire Conference.

Brief summaries of answers to the three questions follow:

1. How can large groups handle the problem of sponsorship?
 - a. Let the new member pick his final sponsor.
 - b. In a group of 100, set up Sponsorship-Hospitality committee of 15-20.
 - c. Let committee assure new member he can choose own sponsor.
 - d. Arrange committee discussions and pre-meeting dinners for newcomers.
 - e. Let Central Committee set up Sponsorship unit, screened locally.
 - f. Designate a "greeter" to welcome both new and old members.
 - g. Arrange beginners' meetings, appoint temporary sponsors.
 - h. Determine where new member lives, have group member offer transportation.
 - i. Give newcomers responsibility more quickly by rotating group jobs faster.
2. Several probation departments and alcoholism programs have made therapy classes compulsory for probationers or patients. A.A. members participate as discussion leaders. How can such "enforced" programs be made more effective as an introduction to A.A.?
 - a. Provide a sponsor who will explain A.A. to alcoholic's family.
- b. Emphasize the attraction of A.A., rather than probationary aspects.
- c. Provide literature, interpret A.A. to officials, offer a good example.
- d. Talk plain, simple A.A. on a voluntary basis.
- e. Provide proper sponsorship immediately.
- f. "No affiliation or participation in 'enforced' program."
- g. Provide effective follow-up.
- h. Be certain qualified and sympathetic A.A.'s participate.
- i. Try to offset negative "compulsory" atmosphere.
- j. Project Twelve Steps as way of life; invite total participation.
3. When groups will not permit Delegate, Committee Members or G.S.R.'s to describe the General Service story, what can be done to break the barrier?
 - a. Arrange separate Third Legacy meetings.
 - b. Assure group of brief, non-statistical report.
 - c. Report only at business meetings of groups.
 - d. Establish a friendly "Fifth Column" in a group by winning over key members.
 - e. Ask questions about G.S.O. activities.
 - f. Encourage selection of interested G.S.R.'s.
 - g. "Use 'Sharing Sessions.'"
 - h. Avoid solicitation of financial support.
 - i. Describe "personal experience" in General Services.
 - j. Weave General Service story into personal story.
 - k. Use "soft sell"; stress functions of General Services, rather than structure.

It was the sense of the meeting that the Table Topics type of presentation should be used at future Conferences.

THE AREA COMMITTEE SHARES ITS EXPERIENCE

As a Fellowship, A.A. has a number of specific responsibilities of service to alcoholics — and many members who are carrying out those responsibilities in productive and occasionally novel ways. Much, but far from all, of this service experience has been recorded at G.S.O. Until now, a basic problem has been to develop ways of permitting local Area Committee Members to expose and share their experience with each other and, through G.S.O. with the rest of the movement.

During the past year with the cooperation of G.S.R.'s and Committee Members on Area Committees in Western Michigan and Southeastern New York, a new approach — the "Sharing Session" — has been tested successfully as a method of focusing attention on 15 basic responsibilities of service in A.A.

1. Sponsorship
2. A.A. Groups
3. Central Offices — Inter-groups
4. Responsibilities to New Groups
5. A.A.'s Relations With Outside Organizations
6. Conference-approved Literature
7. The "Grapevine"
8. Public Relations
9. A.A. and Professional and Business Worlds
10. Institutional Twelfth Step Work
11. International Services
12. General Service Structure
13. Finances
14. A.A. Conventions and Regional Conferences
15. The A.A. and His Years of Sobriety

Two "Sharing Sessions," in Grand Rapids, Mich., and New York City, brought Area Committees and G.S.O. representatives together to explore aspects of these responsibilities of service in a positive, constructive manner.

The reports of both Delegates who participated in the special presentation to the 1963 Conference emphasized several factors that emerged from both sessions. Both Ralph A. (Southeastern N.Y.) and Austin D. (Western Michigan) stressed that the sense of participation felt by G.S.R.'s had helped to create new enthusiasm for supporting the work of G.S.O. They also noted that most who attended the "Sharing Sessions" were amazed to realize that responsibility of financial support of the Office, and for building a General Service structure were only two of a number of important and rewarding responsibilities of A.A. service.

One of the interesting concepts to emerge from the "Sharing Sessions" was the thought that many groups, once they had been adequately informed on the manner in which G.S.O. functions in the area of A.A. responsibility, might be willing to undertake financial support for the Office on a regular basis.

Herb M., Manager of General Services chaired the special presentation, urging Delegates to become interested in the new project. Supplementary data describing the "Sharing Sessions" follows.

'SHARING SESSIONS' - WHAT THEY ARE

What are they? Sharing Sessions are meetings called for the specific purpose of exchanging experiences and ideas about G.S.O. Services.

Who attends? Area Committee Members can hold Sharing Sessions. G.S.R.'s can hold them. Or a Committee Member or a G.S.R. can conduct one for a group. In some cases a "visiting" Delegate or Committee Member can act as leader.

How are they conducted? Sharing Sessions are unlike a discussion meeting or a business meeting in that they keep well away from arguments and conclusions. They are for the purpose of collecting ideas and suggestions from everybody. No member ever need defend his opinion. Sessions are conducted according to modified "brain-storming" rules — with a Chairman who does not participate any more than he needs to — and a time-keeper with a loud bell and a watch (preferably a stopwatch).

The Chairman sets up the question or the problem and asks for volunteers. A participant has his say for 1½ minutes — then the bell. This participant can come back into the picture later — as many times as he chooses provided others have a chance to talk in between.

Each service topic usually takes ninety minutes to two hours. Too much should not be crowded into a short period. Nor should a question be dragged out beyond the interest of a majority.

A stenographer should take the essence of the ideas and suggestions. These notes should be sent to G.S.O. Chairman of a session may be the Area Chairman or a Delegate or a Committee Member or a G.S.R.

What topics are suggested? So that A.A.'s all over the U.S. and Canada can concentrate their experience and ideas on specific subjects, G.S.O. suggests these topics for the first round:

A.A. GROUPS — Types of groups and meeting programs — Special groups — Help for weak groups

A.A. FINANCES — Money in A.A. — Group and Intergroup financial needs — G.S.O. and Area financial needs

How do you get Sharing Sessions started? You need only a meeting place, a chairman who won't get too far into the act himself, a time-keeper who is rugged — and interested A.A.'s. Dip into the two topics suggested and phrase a first question in simple terms. For example —

"A group is having trouble keeping up meeting attendance.

What specific suggestions do you have for getting A.A.'s to come?"

A Sharing Session may be tied into a regular Area Committee meeting or a district meeting, provided enough time can be allowed. It may be included in the program of a regional conference or convention.

Information generated at a Sharing Session is needed at G.S.O. It should be sent to the General Service Conference Secretary, Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York 17 — or to your Area Delegate, or both.

In some Areas, Committee officers are elected only by "outgoing" members of a Committee; in others, only "incoming" Committee Members participate in elections; and in some Areas, members of both "old" and "new" Committees combine to elect officers to carry out Area responsibilities in the field of General Services.

After brief discussion of the various methods, and of the possible need for an "approved" procedure, it was agreed that this was a matter for Area autonomy and that each Area should be free to determine how it wishes to select its Committee officers.

GRAPEVINE REPRESENTATIVE URGED FOR EACH GROUP

Nearly 200 Grapevine Representatives are currently active in groups throughout the movement, Paul C. of the Grapevine Staff, reported during a special presentation on the affairs of A.A.'s international monthly journal. The session was chaired by Mary B., a Trustee of the General Service Board and a Director of the Corporate Board of the magazine.

Others who participated in the presentation included Lee B., who described editorial and publication procedures; Gurney W., who discussed editorial goals and objectives, and Frank N., Chairman of the Grapevine Conference Committee, who discussed plans now underway leading to possible production of a Spanish language edition of the Grapevine.

Grapevine Representatives are fast becoming a vital and active part of many groups, Paula noted. She recalled that the 1959 Conference had approved a plan whereby The Grapevine would have its own representative in each group, independent of the General Service Representative (G.S.R.).

"The GVR sees that the Grapevine is promptly delivered to the group and prominently displayed. He announces its arrival, highlighting articles which are valuable in Twelfth Step work and in the maintenance of sobriety. The GVR aims for 100% group subscription, plus insuring continuance of the monthly bulk single copies on hand for visitors and newcomers. Renewals are carefully checked. Correspondence with The Grapevine is strongly encouraged that we may assist groups where a GVR has been

elected to office. Some groups prefer to continue with their Secretary as the Grapevine contact. But, with the growth of A.A. and the group and the increased activity of the Secretary, it is hoped that a GVR will be nominated and elected as an officer in each group."

Paula reported the following plans have been found effective by GVR's:

1. Grapevine topics in use at all closed meetings.
2. A Grapevine subscription is presented to the three-month newcomer.
3. Each month a Grapevine subscription is raffled in the group.
4. Extra copies of the Grapevine are collected and sent to hospitals, prisons and Loners.
5. The GVR is on the alert for clippings, jokes, anecdotes, quotations as contributions.
6. Professional and nonprofessional writers are recruited. "The articles and stories sent in are the lifeline of the magazine and fulfill the purpose of The Grapevine, which is to share the experiences, strength and hope of all A.A. members."

Modest informational material for GVR's is always available and is encouraged for use at conferences, conventions, area meetings and most important, the local home group, Paula said.

Literature Listings

Discussion was lively and to the point on whether or not newsletters and other inspirational literature published by individual A.A. members and other organizations should be listed in the "World Directory." The overwhelming sense of the meeting was that these newsletters and similar periodicals, while laudable in purpose, should not be listed in the Directory.

It was noted, for instance, that such newsletters reflect individual opinion. Publication of information regarding their availability might thus conceivably imply A.A. endorsement of literature that has not been Conference-approved. By the same token, publication of such information might lead to requests to list the availability of pins, cards and other materials for sale to A.A. members.

New publications are continually being issued, while other newsletters are often suspended. A "World Directory" listing would be quickly out of date. While publication in the "World Directory" is not practical, it was pointed out that the General Service Office maintains a mimeographed list of newsletters and other publications. This list is kept up to date and is available upon request.

'Deluxe' Book

A proposal to publish a "deluxe" edition of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" was discussed at length. When no clear decision emerged, however, it was tabled for further consideration in 1964. Those in favor of publishing a quality pocket-size edition noted that it would, in addition to being more compact, make an appropriate gift item. Other Delegates noted that there would be a lack of enthusiasm, perhaps antagonism, to such an edition, since there was no clearly evident need. One Delegate said that the choice of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Tradition" might lead A.A. members to question why the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous," was not chosen. There was also one opinion that an expensive, deluxe edition, "with the look of a prayer book," might not be appropriate for A.A. One member of the Conference, noting that there seemed to be "considerable objection" to publication of a fine edition, said that the matter should not be considered from the point of view of monetary profit alone. Delegates agreed to table the matter so that it may be discussed in their Areas. The question will be brought up again during the 1964 Conference, it was suggested.

Title Discussed

Should "Alternate" Delegates be called "Assistant" Delegates? And should Delegates' understudies — by any name — receive the same General Service Office mailings that go to Delegates?

These two questions were debated briefly by the Conference, with the following results:

1. There appeared to be no overwhelming demand by the Delegates to make the change from "Alternate" to "Assistant" but there would be no objection if an optional choice of titles were incorporated in a future edition of the "Third Legacy Manual."
2. The General Service Office will place Alternate Delegates on the regular Delegates' mailing list, if desired by the Delegate and if he specifically requests this service.

Links To Loners

Whenever appropriate, Delegates should be encouraged to develop stronger links with Lone A.A. members in their territory. This was the consensus of a number of Delegates who participated in an informal discussion on "How Delegates Serve Loners in Their Areas."

Loners — men and women who are not in a position to affiliate with local groups — should be encouraged to feel that they are part of the Conference structure of A.A., a speaker pointed out.

In some Areas, Loners already take part in Area Assemblies, it was noted. And many Lone members have been responsible for founding A.A. groups in their communities.

The Conference appeared united in supporting further Delegate activity of this type.

'AREA DELEGATES ONLY'

As has been customary at General Service Conferences for many years, Area Delegates to the 1963 Conference were given an opportunity to meet by themselves to exchange Area experience and review proposals that might be presented to the Conference as a whole. Trustees and G.S.O. Staff personnel are always excluded from "Area Delegates Only" meetings.

Matters considered at the 1963 "A.D.O." session included:

1. The desirability of having G.S.O. Staff Members travel more extensively on A.A. Area visits. (It was agreed the increased interest in General Services that could be expected to result from this project would offset additional costs, and that expenses could be shared by neighboring Areas. The possibility of having one Staff Member assigned exclusively to Area travel for a period of a year was also raised.)
2. The plan of A.A. in Hawaii to invite the movement to stage an International Convention in Hawaii in 1970.
3. The possibility of adopting a uniform type of letterhead for use by Area Delegates, at their option. (G.S.O. was asked to explore this matter.)
4. A decision was made to create an informal association of past and present Delegates, to be called "The Delegates' Association," who will meet together at the International Toronto Convention in 1965.
5. "Fifth of the Month Club" money-raising plan, now in use in Alaska.

The following Delegates volunteered to serve on the 1964 Conference Hospitality Committee:

1. Bill L. (Northern New Jersey)
2. Glenn W. (Western Penna.)
3. Paul O. (Eastern Penna.)
4. Jane K. (Central New York)
5. George McA. (Eastern Mass.)
6. Frank J. (Connecticut)
7. C.W. D. (D.C. Area)
8. Ralph A. (Southeastern N.Y.) Chairman

Mac C. of Saskatchewan chaired the meeting. Ruby B., Southeast Texas, was elected chairman for the 1964 "Area Delegates Only" Meeting. Ralph A. was elected to serve as chairman of the Hospitality Committee for 1964.

Delegates' Primary Role

As the scope of both local and world service in A.A. has expanded, local service units (Intergroups and Central Committees) and Third Legacy personnel (Delegates, Areas Committees and General Service Representatives) have become active simultaneously.

In some Areas, questions have arisen concerning the responsibilities and relation of Delegates and Area Committees to the local service units. Should a Delegate, for example, act as an "arm" of the General Service Office and should he mediate when disputes arise in his territory?

A somewhat complicating factor develops occasionally when representatives of various viewpoints write directly to G.S.O. requesting a solution to a local problem.

Approximately a dozen Delegates commented on this problem on the basis of personal experience. While no formal vote was sought, there appeared to be general agreement on the following:

1. Delegates should "intervene" in local disputes only when asked, and
2. Delegates should make their services available in "conflict" situations only when an issue or problem is likely to affect A.A. as a whole.

TRUSTEE SELECTIONS

The 1962 Conference had recommended enlarging the General Service Board from 15 to 19 members through the addition of two nonalcoholic Trustees and two A.A. Trustees. The Conference had also recommended adoption of a six-Region zoning plan, each Region to be eligible to elect a Trustee at six-year intervals. Both recommendations were adopted by the Board.

Since the end of the 1962 Conference, the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board, working closely with the Conference Committee on Trustees, had established procedures leading to the nomination of Trustee candidates from the Southwest, Pacific and East Central Regions.

Final selection of Area Trustee nominees was accomplished at the 1963 Conference, in accordance with accepted Third Legacy procedures and the special procedures developed by the Board and Conference committees.

Each state within each Region — following Third Legacy procedures — had earlier selected a candidate to represent the Region. Those eligible to vote for the Trustee nominee from each Region included the Area Delegates from states within the Region, members of the Conference Committee on Trustees and members of the General Service Board Nominating Committee.

A full evening session was set aside for the balloting at the 1963 Conference. Only the qualified voters described above took part in the balloting but other members of the Conference were invited to observe the proceedings.

Results of the balloting were as follows, the Trustee nominees being:

Southwest Region — Roy S. (Oklahoma)
East Central Region — Howard B. (Ohio)
Pacific Region — Jim M. (Calif.)

OTHER TRUSTEE NOMINEES

In other proceedings, the Conference approved the nominations of two nonalcoholic Trustees to fill vacancies created through enlargement of the General Service Board. The nominees:

Dr. Harvey Cruickshank of Toronto, Canada, a vice president and general manager of Bell Telephone Company of Canada, and

The Hon. John M. Murtagh, Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York City.

Both nominees are well known for their experience and knowledge in the field of alcoholism, and as warm friends of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The Conference further approved the nomination of Eugene K. as an A.A. Trustee from the New York Area, to replace Sum C., whose term expired this year.

Relation To Al-Anon

As early as 1952, Delegates to a General Service Conference were recorded as approving the work of Bill and Lois W. in encouraging the sound growth of the Al-Anon Family Group movement. Paralleling this support has been the consistent attitude that A.A. and Al-Anon, while closely linked in many Areas, are separate and distinct movements and in no way formally related.

A 1963 Conference discussion session on "The Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon" disclosed some divergence of personal attitudes toward the Family Groups but virtual unanimity in reaffirming the traditional relationship between A.A. and Al-Anon.

Special 'Observers' Reports

FRANCE

By a conservative estimate there are today between 250 and 300 active French-speaking A.A.'s in France, "with another 200 to 300 alcoholics playing around the fringes," Nick H., the Observer representing French A.A., told the Delegates.

The recent accelerated growth of a "native" A.A. movement has been due largely to the publication in the summer of 1960 of a notable series of articles by Joseph Kessel, a well-known writer who had studied the Fellowship (with G.S.O. help) on a trip to the U.S. Earlier, attempts to activate French-speaking groups had met with repeated failure.

In Paris, where most of the growth has occurred, three meetings (one open) are held each week. Other groups have been established in Roubaix, Rouen, Marseilles, Tourcoing and Bordeaux, and there are a number of Lone members.

Nick paid special tribute to a number of nonalcoholic friends of A.A. who helped with translation service when correspondence flooded in and who made it possible to protect the integrity of the A.A. name through incorporation of a service board. Publication of the Kessel articles in book form and the appearance of articles on A.A. in several leading magazines have continued to contribute to growth of the Society in France, Nick said. Several television programs have also been devoted to A.A. Approximately one-third of the membership consists of women alcoholics and the Al-Anon movement has helped stabilize recent growth of A.A. itself, Nick noted.

INTERNATIONALISTS

For the first time in the history of the General Service Conference, the Internationalists Group of Seamen was represented by an Observer. He was Captain Jack S., founder of the unique group which today numbers approximately 265 members, seven of them women.

The group was started October 27, 1947, when Captain Jack received orders to go to the Far East and, unsure of his 15 months of sobriety, visited the General Service Office "to get advice on how to stay sober alone without the help of fellow members."

Captain Jack paid tribute to Bill and the Office Staff members of that period who encouraged him to believe that he could retain his sobriety away from personal contact with A.A., and who renewed their encouragement regularly through correspondence.

The Internationalist recalled his first traveling A.A. contact, with Frank F. of Palembang, Sumatra, and the circumstances of the first A.A. meeting on an American ship, the "Stanvac Durban," in Australian waters.

NETHERLANDS

The year 1962 was a year of rebirth and renewed inspiration for A.A. in The Netherlands, Adrian F., the Conference Observer for Holland, pointed out in a brief but moving report to the Delegates.

Rapid growth of A.A. in Holland in the past few years had caused the Dutch General Service Board to become concerned about the possible lack of spiritual depth throughout the movement in that country, Adrian recalled. As a result, he said, the Board late in 1961 had circulated a letter to the entire membership, pointing out the importance of full acceptance of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

A further consequence, during the summer of 1962, was the staging of a General Convention with three special presentations; on Recovery, Unity and Service. Copies of the presentation were reproduced and are being widely used as the basis for discussion at closed meetings throughout the country.

Membership now is growing steadily but solidly, Adrian declared, and relations with press, radio, television and various official agencies concerned with the problem of alcoholism are excellent.

NORWAY

A.A. is today solidly entrenched in Norway, Hart S., veteran Observer representing groups in that country told the 1963 Conference. Hart has been noted for many years for his devoted service in behalf of the Fellowship in his native Norway and in other Scandinavian countries.

Harmony reigned among the groups represented at the National Conference in Trondheim last Summer, Hart said, although group contributions for the support of the national service agencies were still lagging.

Groups that had "seceded" in past years during debates over self-support and other Traditional A.A. matters voluntarily "returned to the fold" during the year.

Norway is one of the few non-English-speaking countries with extensive A.A. literature of its own, including a "composite" Big Book containing personal stories, the Twelve Traditions and excerpts from "A.A. Comes of Age." Inter-group services offices have been set up and A.A. programs in institutions are getting under way.

Dramatizing the increasing adherence to Traditional A.A. principles, the administrative agency formerly known as the "Central Leadership" unit has changed its name to "National Advisory Board," and will limit its functions to those of an advisory nature. A number of Conference-approved items of literature were translated into Norwegian and distributed to the groups by the National Secretariat during 1962, Hart said.

FINLAND

Inadequate knowledge of A.A. Tradition at one time hampered the sound growth of the Fellowship in Finland but this situation has been corrected and Finnish A.A. recently celebrated its fifteenth anniversary in a strong position. Aarne H. reported to the Delegates. Finland has for many years had one of the strongest overseas A.A. service structures and marked a "first" in the General Service Conference by providing transportation for an Observer to the Conference.

At present there are an estimated 2,000 members in 125 groups in 42 communities, Aarne said, not including 16 prison groups and four hospital groups. There are 213 weekly A.A. meetings, most of them closed, throughout the country, as well as more than 20 institutional meetings. A few groups have experimented with open meetings and so-called public information meetings are arranged occasionally by some groups. National Conferences are held quarterly and there are six regional Conferences each year.

SWEDEN

Traditional A.A. in Sweden seems to be in better shape than it ever has been, Ralph B., American volunteer Observer, reported.

Total membership is still relatively small, and difficult to gauge precisely. There are between 75 and 100 members in Stockholm, by far the largest city in the Kingdom, and perhaps another 100 members throughout the remainder of the country. There are small groups in several Swedish cities but a large number of alcoholics who are staying sober on the A.A. program are not "registered" formally. This is because considerable risk still attaches to public identification as an alcoholic.

The main Stockholm Group holds two meetings a week, with relatively little overlapping in attendance. A typical Thursday evening meeting attracts 30 or more persons. A high percentage of the members are fluent in English.

One of the notable developments of the past year has been the increasingly effective work of the "Central Committee for A.A. in Sweden," formed a year ago with representatives from a number of the Swedish groups. A primary objective of the Committee is to serve as a reliable clearing house of information on Traditional A.A. both within and outside the Fellowship.

G.S.B. Public Information Committee

(Allan B., Chairman)

The Public Information Committee of the General Service Board was formed in January, 1956 as a subcommittee of the Policy Committee. It is now a regular standing committee of the Board of Trustees. However, its actions are still subject to approval by the Policy Committee and the Trustees and it is bound to adhere to A.A. Traditions in all public relations and to the Policy Statement entitled "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed," which was approved by the 1961 Conference.

Originally an advisory committee to the General Service Office, for the past four years P.I.C. has functioned as a working group actively engaged in sustaining A.A.'s sound movement-wide public relations. The committee holds regular monthly meetings and designated members of the committee meet in connection with special projects whenever necessary.

P.I.C. cooperates with all public information media to improve public understanding of the A.A. program while preventing misunderstanding of the Fellowship. The committee works to maintain sound relationships with outside agencies and supplies information and special materials to assist local groups and areas in their public information activities.

Cooperation with Media

A mailing of basic information about A.A. was made during the summer of 1962 to authors of textbooks on social and health problems.

On September 5, 1962, P.I.C. released A.A.'s second annual "Report to the General Public," constituting a summary of the highlights of the 1962 Conference Report, to a list of broadcasting and publishing personnel who have asked to receive such information. It was also sent to local and area P.I. Committees for adaptation to local conditions and release in their areas. The release was carried by both the Associated Press and the United Press and received excellent coverage throughout the country as well as abroad.

On November 15, the Board of Trustees sponsored another "Gratitude Luncheon" for media people who have made a special contribution to A.A. during the recent past. Bill spoke informally, expressing the movement's gratitude to publishers, editors, broadcasters and writers for their support and encouragement of the A.A. program.

The Public Information Committee cooperated with the writer and producers of the motion picture film, "Days of Wine and Roses," and previewed the film before its premiere in New York on January 17. It is the opinion of the Committee that those parts of the film that pertain to A.A. are accurately portrayed.

Relations with Outside Agencies

The Public Information Committee has the responsibility for maintaining communications and relations with organizations which function in the field of alcoholism outside A.A.

On October 8-11, the P.I.C. Chairman and Secretary represented the Board of Trustees at the annual meeting of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs in Bismarck, N.D. The Chairman was given ample time to present the background and policies on A.A.'s relations with outside agencies.

The Chairman has also been invited to discuss A.A.'s relations with outside agencies at the annual national conference of the National Council on Alcoholism on April 19 and at the Rutgers School of Alcohol Studies (formerly the Yale School) during its 1963 sessions.

On December 11, a meeting was held at the General Service Office, attended by members of the Executive Committee of NAAAP, members of P.I.C. the G.S.O. Staff and Bill. Problems involving relations between A.A. and state and provincial agencies in certain areas were discussed and the meeting served to improve mutual understanding of our respective positions.

Problems involving retreats and other essentially religious meetings attended by A.A. members have been the subject of considerable study by P.I.C. From time to time, newspaper articles appear regarding these retreat meetings, or other incidents occur, which have created the erroneous impression that A.A. sponsors or is affiliated with some of the retreats. P.I.C. therefore prepared a question and answer on this subject for addition to the "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" booklet. This statement has been approved by the Board of Trustees and has been submitted to the Conference Committee on A.A.'s Relations with Outside Agencies with the recommendation that it be submitted to the 1963 Conference for approval.

Special Projects

Considerable time was devoted to exploring possible methods of improving knowledge of A.A. in and by the Armed Services. It was concluded that no special measures need be adopted at this time.

At present, the Committee is investigating means of improving understanding of A.A. by the medical profession and measures by which it may be made easier for doctors who wish to do so to refer patients to A.A.

G.S.O. Information Activities

(Anita R.)

During 1962, the General Service Office received more than 6,000 requests for information on A.A. These were from alcoholics, families and friends of alcoholics, students, teachers, doctors, clergymen, librarians, researchers and writers. Each inquiry was acknowledged and appropriate literature sent.

The A.A. professional exhibit was shown in 1962 at five professional conferences. Since we now have two exhibits, the 1963 schedule includes nine meetings or conferences.

The exhibit is manned by local A.A. members, and the responsibility of covering it is usually assumed by a local Public Information Committee or the General Service Conference Delegate or both. The leaflet, "Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism," is available for distribution, and a form may be filled in by visitors requesting material in various categories.

Our Press Clipping Bureau sent us 3,287 domestic and 876 foreign clippings in 1962 which mentioned Alcoholics Anonymous. There were only a small number of anonymity breaks, and in these cases a letter explaining our Tradition of anonymity, a reprint of "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous" and a copy of the 1961 letter reaffirming the Tradition were sent.

Services to Internationalists

(Midge McF.)

The 1962 Conference voted that the Internationalist Group have an Observer at future General Service Conferences. In true Third Legacy fashion, — through the mail — the Internationalist Group unanimously elected Captain Jack S. as their Observer.

There are now 265 Internationalist members. Seven of these are women. Eleven countries outside the United States and Canada are represented: England (17), Australia (5), Ireland (3), Holland (1), Spain (1), Singapore (1), Sweden (1), Denmark (1), Japan (1) and Norway (1).

These members frequently attend A.A. conventions around the world. A number were participants at the 1962 Weisbaden, West Germany, Round-Up and the first Hawaii State Convention.

Annually each member receives a "World Directory" to help with A.A. contacts, as well as a list of Internationalist members for correspondence purposes. This list is kept updated during the year.

The Internationalists exchange letters with each other and with G.S.O. They also receive a monthly "Round Robin" from G.S.O.

A.A. Overseas

(Eve M.)

English-Speaking Areas

New groups in English-speaking areas overseas indicate A.A. continues to develop in these areas. Complimentary literature, a Directory, and information on local services are sent immediately. The "Exchange Bulletin," as well as correspondence and all service material is shared with all English-speaking overseas groups. There has been a comparable development of service and service committees. Annual conferences and conventions have been established. A.A.'s in England, Scotland and Ireland hold annual meetings in April, May and October; meetings in Australia and South Africa are generally held over Easter Weekend, with the Rhodesia and Nyasaland meeting in July.

In overseas areas, an increasing understanding of A.A. and alcoholism is evident. The Minister of Health in Great Britain has recommended that all hospitals in the U.K. contact local A.A. groups. In several areas the equivalent to State Commissions have been established (Australia, New Zealand and South Africa). "Cooperation but not Affiliation" has been a helpful tool and in the English-speaking areas there is increasing understanding of A.A.'s relationship to these agencies.

In all English-speaking A.A., the Traditions seem to be clearly understood. In some instances, anonymity is more zealously guarded than in the States.

Other Language Areas

A.A. in the Spanish-speaking areas has been developing rapidly over the past four or five years. It has been helped immeasurably as a result of the 1962 Conference recommendations. Additional Spanish literature has been made available at a cost better equated to the economies of these Spanish-speaking countries. An increase in sales as well as in complimentary literature has resulted, with the number of groups increasing from 206 groups in 1962 to 300 in 1963.

The Spanish Bulletin is mailed monthly to all groups listed, and bulk copies are sent to Intergroups and Service Committees when requested. Spanish service material in mimeograph form on Public Information, Conferences and Conventions, Prison and Hospital information has helped development in these areas. The public meeting as a way of celebrating a group's anniversary has become popular in Central and South America, with tremendous cooperation among all groups.

Busloads of A.A.'s go from one country to another in Central America. These frequently are in themselves a way of attracting attention to A.A. In one instance, the President of Guatemala asked about the purpose of a caravan of buses carrying more than 600 El Salvador A.A. members. He then not only invited them to the presidential palace, but also attended the public meeting the following morning.

French-speaking groups abroad continue to develop. The translations into French of Conference-approved literature, made available through the French Literature Council in Montreal, now also include the "composite" book. An increase in

groups not only in France, but in French-speaking Switzerland and Belgium has resulted. An Intergroup Bulletin, from Lausanne, is distributed to all French-speaking groups.

Structural problems occur in some instances, due to legal technicalities in each country. Belgium has had some difficulties due to the dual language problem there, but the Intergroup in Liege has begun to function well.

At the Conference last year we reported that there were three German-speaking groups. Today there are over 40. At the recommendation of last year's Conference, we prepared an introductory pamphlet, "How A.A. Starts and How It Grows." This has been translated into German and distributed to all groups there. In addition, the "Twelve Steps" and "Twelve Traditions," in two separate pamphlets, are also now available in German. There is every indication that German-speaking A.A. will make rapid progress. There is a monthly German Bulletin, supported by contributions from all groups, and we are invited to "share our experience" with them. The Big Book, chapters 1 through 11, will also be available before long.

The cooperation of the many Armed Forces in groups in Berlin and throughout West Germany has been of tremendous help to the new German-speaking groups. The annual Roundup at Wiesbaden, originally all English-speaking, is now a multiple-language all-European affair.

In Japan, three all-Japanese groups are translating our literature, and the members, when possible, attend English-speaking meetings. The American groups in Japan cooperate with these Japanese groups wholeheartedly, and are themselves making continuing progress.

The English-speaking groups in Bombay, New Delhi and Calcutta have continued to make progress. Approximately 500 copies each of four basic pamphlets were sent by G.S.O. to India on a complimentary basis. With the sale of these, the Indian groups hope to establish a Service Center for all groups. In addition, they have already completed the translations of two pamphlets into three of the major Indian languages, and may need help with the printing costs.

The Traditional groups in Norway continue to grow. Their Conference will be held in June. In Sweden, a Central Committee headquartered in Stockholm is proving effective in strengthening both internal and external public relations. Finland which has probably developed further than almost any of the other overseas areas, has had its own Board and literature program for many years. The Big Book in Finnish has been made available, and a translation of the "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" will be ready this summer.

Holland, which has had some "Traditional" problems, arranged a Conference relating specifically to Recovery, Unity and Service. It was most successful. Dutch members plan another this October, to bring better understanding of Service and the Traditions. Similar problems are apparent in some of the Flemish parts of A.A. in Belgium. The introductory pamphlet, "How A.A. Starts and How It Grows," is available in mimeograph form in Flemish. It should help to clarify the Traditions and solve some of the problems.

G.S.B. Policy Committee

(B. Patrick C., Chairman)

The Policy Committee has the responsibility of advising Trustees on matters of policy to be considered at quarterly Board meetings. Policy Committee meetings are held quarterly on the Sunday prior to each Board meeting.

There are ten voting members of the Policy Committee, but all Trustees, A.A. World Service Directors, Grapevine Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staff, and members of the Public Information Committee are invited to attend and participate in Policy Committee discussions.

During the past year, more than 20 items of business were referred to the General Service Board for its consideration and action. They are all included in other reports, either of the General Service Board itself, or of one of its committees.

Loners and Loner Sponsors

(Ann M.)

There are now 637 Loner members on our records at G.S.O., including Spanish-speaking Loners. A monthly sharing of excerpts from their own letters called "Loners Meeting" goes out to each registrant monthly. At present, Spanish members receive only the monthly Spanish Bulletin.

Special material, culled from the experiences of other Loners and called "For the Lone Member," is also sent to each loner that registers. With it go one each of all pamphlets, the "World Directory" and a supplementary listing of all Loners (compiled monthly). This supplementary listing is sent to all Loner Sponsors registered with us, so that they can write to the new members. There are 128 of these sponsors presently listed. These are A.A.'s who have expressed an interest in doing this kind of Twelfth Step work.

A.A. Groups in Institutions

(Midge McF.)

Probably the greatest single problem of inmate members is that of sponsorship upon release. Correspondence indicates that many inmates expect from A.A. help in the way of jobs, clothing, housing and smoothing family situations. They feel let down when these things — so important to them — are not available through A.A. Their cry is: "You say you will help, but you don't do anything."

During the past year there has been continued A.A. growth in prisons. More inmates are attending meetings and participating. Discussion groups and orientation groups are increasing in prisons. Many new hospitals have started holding regular A.A. meetings and requests are frequently made by hospital administrators for information as to how to start an A.A. group.

There is a definite trend toward establishing A.A. groups or contacts in county jails.

In October, it was decided to take advantage of a 3,000 inventory of the *old edition* of "Alcoholics Anonymous" by offering books for institutional use *only*, at three copies for five dollars. Since that time over 1200 books have been placed in institutions.

The services available to A.A. groups in institutions and groups and committees interested in working with these institution groups are:

1. Mimeographed service material containing "Suggestions for the Formation of an A.A. Group in Prison"
2. "Suggestions for Institutions Committees"
3. "Directory of A.A. Groups in Hospitals" and "Directory of A.A. Groups in Correctional Facilities" compiled annually in the fall.
4. Initial supply of literature sent to all new groups in institutions as well as "Exchange Bulletin" sent to all groups each month.
5. Four dollars and a half worth of literature for three dollars is available in specially prepared packages for hospitals, women's prisons and men's prisons.
6. Sharing of institution group experience through correspondence.
7. "Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A." is being updated.

Steady growth of A.A. in institutions is reflected in the number of existing groups as of March 15:

Prison Groups	561	Institution Committees	68
Hospital Groups	479	Hospital Prison Sponsors	472

Group Records and Directory

(Anita R.)

The 1962 procedures for the "A.A. World Directory" were repeated in obtaining and compiling information for the 1963 issue.

1. Group Information Cards were mailed to groups in November.
2. One address was requested to be used as a mailing address and also for Directory listing.
3. Two phone numbers were requested for each group.
4. If all members are included in other group counts, this should be indicated by using an "x."

For the first time, Delegates, Chairmen of General Service Conference Area Committees were listed in the Directory (if the information was given us). The General Service Area of the group was also indicated wherever that data was filled in on cards returned.

Special Census Cards were included with the mailing requesting Directory information. The results of the Special Census indicate that the total A.A. membership is approximately 310,000. One in every 5 members is a woman, and one in every 35 is 25 years of age or under.

Literature Committee

(Ivan Underwood, Chairman)

Significant activities of the G.S.B. Literature Committee included the following:

New descriptive order forms for Conference-approved books and pamphlets were distributed in September.

"The G.S.R.," a pamphlet based on material obtained through questionnaires sent to all G.S.R.'s, was prepared and made available.

"Cooperation but not Affiliation," a service piece primarily, was priced and included in the order form to acquaint groups with its availability.

The revision of "The Alcoholic Employee" was completed and retitled "A.A. and Alcoholic Employee." Copies were distributed to those in industry who had assisted in its preparation.

Reprints of John Park Lee's article "A.A. and the Social Worker" were obtained through the magazine "Social Work" and are used in answering inquiries at G.S.O. from social workers.

The Committee suggested a continuing review of existing literature to see that it includes sufficient reference to early stages of alcoholism.

The Committee felt that further review was necessary before an introductory comic-strip type of A.A. pamphlet could be entertained.

In reviewing the pamphlets, presently published locally, and referred to it by the Conference Literature Committee for consideration as Conference — approved literature, the Committee felt that these fulfilled local needs and should continue to be published locally.

The Committee approved the service material recommended by the 1962 Conference for translation into appropriate languages and also noted the translation of this material, "How A.A. Starts and How It Grows," into Spanish and German.

Discussed pocket gift edition of "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," and suggested that the matter should go to the Conference for further exploration and discussion.

The A.A. Grapevine, Incorporated

(Mary B.)

Chairman: Corporate Board

At the start of the new year The Corporate Board of The A.A. Grapevine accepted the resignation of two of its Directors, Robert MacD. and Max W. These men gave long and generous service to the Grapevine and its Board, for which all of us feel a deep appreciation.

At the 1963 January Quarterly Meeting, the following new Directors were elected and welcomed to the Board: Lee B., Staff Director, Yev G., Jay A. J., Charles E. L. and G.W.

The year ending December 31, 1962 showed a profit of \$5,703.15. In view of the fact that in 1962 The Grapevine went through considerable organizational changes which necessitated payments of severance (non-recurring items), we feel that the year ahead shows a very healthy financial picture.

The steady climb in circulation from 35,478 in December 1961, to 40,681 in December 1962, an increase of 5,203, is most encouraging.

With satisfaction at our present position, the corporate Board has budgeted the year 1963 for a profit of \$4,700.

FINANCIAL SUMMARY OF THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

Subscription Income: 1961 — \$74,616; 1962 — \$82,945; Increase \$8,329

Circulation: December Issue: 1961 — 35,478; 1962 — 40,681; Increase 4,203

Cost per copy: 1961 — 30.57¢; 1962 — 30.24¢; Decrease .33¢

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

(Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman)

The General Service Board of Trustees held their quarterly meetings during the past year on the last Monday of April, July, October and January. Individual Trustees also served as Chairmen of the Committees of the General Service Board — Policy, Nominating, Finance, Literature and Public Information. These Committees met quarterly, prior to the Board meetings; except for the Public Information Committee which met monthly. Two of the Trustees serve as Directors of A.A.W.S., Inc. which met monthly. Two Trustees served as Directors of the Grapevine Board, Inc. which met quarterly, and also on the Grapevine Editorial Board, which met monthly.

Following are some of the recommendations approved by the General Service Board during the past year —

1. That Booklets on Bill's "Twelve Concepts" and on Bill's recommendations concerning the General Service Board be published and made available for free distribution.
2. That the sum of not more than \$5,000 be authorized to be taken from the General Fund to be used in preparing and distributing non-English A.A. literature. The direction of this fund is to be in the hands of A.A.W.S. Directors.
3. That the recommendation of the subcommittee of Electoral Procedures which included the establishment of six Regions in the United States (for the purpose of electing Regional Class B Trustees) be approved.
4. Resolved that the Certificate of Incorporation of the corporation of the General Service Board be amended to provide that the number of Directors shall include nine (9) Class B or A.A. Trustees and ten (10) Class A or nonalcoholic Trustees. The bylaws were similarly changed.
5. That P.I.C. be authorized to submit question and answer on Retreats to the Conference Committee on A.A.'s Relations with Outside Organizations.
6. Re the 1965 Convention Fund, the Board excuted a corporate resolution authorizing that \$6,500 from the General Fund be placed in a thrift account of the Chase Manhattan Bank and that this amount be used for the Convention Guarantee Fund account.
7. That "distributed with approval of the General Service Conference" be put on all reprints such as "Fortune" and "Saturday Evening Post," subject to Conference approval.
8. That the following be A.A.'s reaction and action in regard to the February "Harper's" magazine article on A.A. —
 - a. G.S.O. make no direct rejoinder to "Harper's" magazine.
 - b. Bill W. and the "Grapevine" be asked to publish an article useful to the movement in dealing with the criticism inherent in the article.
 - c. Participants in "The Fellowship Takes Its Inventory" presentation at the 13th Annual Meeting of the Conference keep the author's criticism in mind in preparing their subject material.
9. That the Public Information Committee, formerly a subcommittee of the Policy Committee, become a full committee of the General Service Board.
10. That a resolution be sent to the French Literature Council of Quebec expressing the gratitude of the General Service Board for the work they have done on the translation of A.A. literature.

13th ANNUAL MEETING - GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF A.A.

April 24-28, 1963 Hotel Roosevelt, New York

Theme — "OUR COMMON WELFARE"

Wednesday, April 24

Registration and Tour of G.S.O.

Welcome Session; Reports from General Service Staff; Selection of Conference Committees

Opening Dinner; Invocation and Greetings — Lois and Bill; A.A. Meeting

Thursday, April 25

Reports on G.S.B.; Policy Committee; Public Information Committee. "Area Highlights"; Reports on Finance Committee; Literature Committee; General Service Manager's and A.A.W.S. Report.

"Ask-It Basket" Questions; "Area Highlights"; Report from Finnish Observer.

Showing of G.S.O. Film after Luncheon.

Presentation: "The Area Committee Shares Its Experience."

"Area Highlights"; Discussions; "Ask-It Basket" Questions

Dinner — Area Delegates Only

Informal Get-Together for Overseas Observers

Friday, April 26

Grapevine Reports; Discussions; Report of Area Delegates Only meeting; "Ask-It Basket" Questions; "Area Highlights"

Showing of G.S.O. Film after Luncheon

"Table Topics" for all Delegates (Sponsorship; Outside Organizations; Communication); Discussions; "Ask-It Basket" Questions

Dinner followed by three consecutive Nominating Sessions to Determine Trustee Candidate for each of three regions

Saturday, April 27

"Area Highlights," Nominating Committee Report; Discussions; Reports from Observers — Internationalists, France, Holland, Norway, Sweden

Presentation: "Our Common Welfare"; 1965 Convention report; Luncheon

"Area Highlights"; Reports from Conference Committees

Presentation: "The Fellowship Takes Its Inventory"; "Ask-It Basket" Questions

Sunday, April 28

Final Conference session — Brunch — Talks by Chairman of Area Delegates Meeting, by Chairman of the General Service Board, by outgoing Trustees and by Bill. Adjournment

Visit to Lois' and Bill's home, "Stepping Stones"

Group Services

(Ann M.)

The number of groups served by the General Service Office is now 10,070 worldwide. In 1962, 1,280 new groups were registered (386 were inactivated). Seven hundred and ninety-seven were in the United States and Canada, 302 overseas, 84 in hospitals and 97 in prisons. There are 51 young people's groups registered, 151 women's groups, 17 American Indian groups, 48 TB hospital groups, 168 Central Offices, 90 Armed Forces Loners — indicating the variety of A.A. experience available to share. In January and February of 1963, 324 new groups were added — 186 in the United States and Canada and 108 overseas, 13 in prisons and 17 in hospitals.

Each group registering receives a letter, free literature, copies of the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" and the "World Directory." Throughout the year G.S.O. keeps in continuing touch with many of these groups through correspondence and the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin."

Current Service To Groups

After the initial service of providing new groups with literature and the "World Directory," the following group services are provided:

1. Filling group literature orders.
2. Mailing the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" (8 issues are planned for 1963.)
3. Exchanging correspondence dealing with group problems.
4. Continuing to supply the group with the "World Directory" annually, and other pamphlets or service pieces as they are created.

Typical Services Requested By Groups

1. Suggestions for speakers at conferences and conventions.
(a) Requests for Staff, Trustee or A.A.W.S. Director participation in a conference or convention.
2. Suggestions for arrangements for conference or convention.
3. Suggestions for open and closed meetings.
4. Suggestions for group structure.
5. Suggestions in reference to clubhouses.
6. Suggestions in reference to local public relations.
7. Requests for correspondents for group members who are traveling or temporarily isolated from the group.
8. Requests for information in reference to the structure of
9. Intergroups, Central Offices and Steering Committees.
9. Clarification and interpretation of Traditions.
10. Requests for correspondence or sponsorship for alcoholics in languages other than English.
11. Requests for information in reference to rest homes, hospitals and doctors.

Staff Services

(Hazel R., Staff Coordinator)

From its inception in 1940, G.S.O. has had but one purpose, providing service to the Fellowship by sharing the movement's accumulated, worldwide experience.

During the past year, the Service Staff attempted to strengthen its usefulness to the Society through a coordinated program of analysing and evaluating present services and attempting to estimate and anticipate future needs. In effect, total Staff experience was applied to all areas of G.S.O. service.

More than 36,000 pieces of incoming mail were handled by the Staff during the year. Of these, approximately 12,000 required research and individual responses.

Exchanging A.A. information and experience with visitors to G.S.O. continued to be a significant activity. More than 900 members, many from overseas, visited the Office during the past year.

Staff members were privileged to visit more than 25 Area Assemblies, Conferences and Conventions. Following each visit, written reports were shared with other Staff members.

All evidence available at G.S.O. indicates a healthy growth of interest in, and knowledge of, General Services on the part of A.A. members.

12. Requests for information about forming groups in the Armed Services or information about dealing with specialized problems that may arise in such groups.
13. Requests for taped A.A. talks.
14. Requests for specialized help for blind and deaf alcoholics and others with physical handicaps.
15. Requests for help in starting groups in institutions and forming Institutional Committees

All of these requests can be met with current service material which is reviewed and updated periodically. (A listing of this material is available.)

Many groups write in to present group problems which they feel are blocking the true purpose of the group, which is to help the alcoholic to sobriety. Most of these problems can be solved through referral to the Twelve Traditions. Copies of the pamphlet, "The A.A. Traditions," accompany the answer to these letters.

New Services

1. A quarterly Intergroup and Central Office Exchange Bulletin.
2. A listing of Intergroup and Central Office newsletters
3. A separate listing of Intergroups and Central Offices.
4. Women's sponsorship, through correspondence, of A.A. women in need of special help.
5. Tape library. (Ten meeting tapes are available at G.S.O.)

Change of Name for "Partners"

Many groups are still asking for "The Secretary's Manual," a handbook which was formerly distributed to each group secretary who registered a new group with G.S.O. The pamphlet "Partners in A.A." replaced the Manual, but apparently the name is not sufficiently descriptive. The new title will be: "The A.A. Group Handbook — How The Group Starts and How It Grows."

In 1963, there will be eight issues of the "Bulletin." March is omitted, as it is the month devoted to the Spring Appeal Letter. The Conference Digest has always replaced the June issue. *July and August* issues are to be combined, as are those for *September and October*. (The Fall Appeal Letter will be mailed with the *September and October* combined issue. If this new schedule is agreeable to the groups, it will be continued.)

Conference Notes

DELEGATES ENTHUSIASTIC ABOUT NEW G.S.O. FILM STRIP

Delegates were uniformly enthusiastic (with one exception) about the new film strip describing General Service Office operations. All but a handful of Delegates had screened the presentation at least once. Many Delegates commented that it was the most effective device for stimulating support of A.A.'s movement-wide services that they have ever seen.

NEED FOR BETTER LIAISON WITH DOCTORS DESCRIBED

Some groups are extremely effective in acquainting doctors in their community of the help available to alcoholics through A.A., but much more work could be done locally in this field.

That was the gist of an interim report of the G.S.B. Public Information Committee which is currently exploring ways in which A.A. can cooperate more effectively with professional groups. The report on the preliminary survey of group experience with doctors was made by Niles P., P.I.C. member.

General Service Conference

(Beth K.)

The G.S.O. mailing list now carries approximately 1,110 Committee Members. This is an increase of 160 over last year.

There are 84 Delegates. For the first time this year, an Observer from Finland was sent to the Conference, and also for the first time the Internationalists (Seamen) had an Observer present. Other Observers represented are: Norway, Sweden and France.

Observers had the privilege of the floor during the Conference but no votes. Responsibility for their expenses was not assumed by the General Service Board or Conference.

Ex-Delegates remain on the G.S.O. mailing list and, to date, there are 348.

An "Interim Report" was mailed quarterly to Conference Delegates and Committee Members reporting activities of A.A.'s General Service Board and A.A. World Services, Inc.

During the year, Conference Committees have been kept advised and consulted concerning all activities of the General Service Board Committees.

During the past year, letters received at G.S.O. indicate the following tools have been helpful:

1. Conference Display Boards for Local Area Conventions - routed to eight Areas.

2. The sound filmstrip describing G.S.O. services. (Shown throughout the year in more than half the states and all Canadian provinces.)
3. Listing of Area Committee Chairmen. (Mailed to all Chairmen.)
4. Film, "Faith for Today." (Mailed to Delegates and Committee Members.)

It has been evident for some time that there is a marked need for G.S.O. to have access to more experience of A.A.'s everywhere. The first step toward filling this need was taken with the holding of "Two Experimental Sharing Sessions" for General Service Area Committee Members and G.S.R.'s - one in Southeastern New York, the other in Western Michigan. These Sessions dealt with topics such as "The A.A. Group - Attendance and Programing," "Finances in A.A.," and "Relations with Outside Organizations." Results of the "Sharing Sessions" dealing with A.A.'s "Responsibilities of Service" will be discussed at this Conference.

In order for G.S.O. to help share the experience of Area Committees it was necessary first to find out just what Committee Members do. G.S.O. asked all Committee Members to comment on their exact duties and more than half of the areas and all the provinces responded describing their activities.

A.A. World Services, Inc./G.S.O.

(Herb M., Chairman)

A.A. World Services, Inc. is the corporation responsible for the service operations at G.S.O., and for publishing of Conference-approved books and literature. It is a membership corporation and its legal members are the Directors of the General Service Board. Its A.A. and non-A.A. Staff includes 33 full-time and three part-time workers.

PUBLISHING: The dollar sale of books and pamphlets in 1962 ran 13.6% ahead of 1961 (which in turn was 10% ahead of the previous year). Publishing and distribution of books and pamphlets are an important part of A.A.W.S. operations since the publishing net (sales less costs) contributes to the operations of G.S.O. Publishing operations carry a heavy share of the overhead and what is left over at the end of the year is an important addition to total operating revenues.

In 1962, A.A.W.S. authorized the distribution of 130,000 pieces of free literature costing \$5,831, plus shipping costs. It also reprinted foreign language literature to meet the needs of low economy countries - particularly in Latin America.

Distribution of all books and pamphlets and miscellaneous items in 1962 is as follows:

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	30,000
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions	10,674
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	3,461
Alcoholics Anonymous - Spanish	715
	<u>44,859</u>

PAMPHLETS

This is A.A.	109,854
A.A. - 44 Questions & Answers.....	99,979
Is A.A. for You?	129,368
Partners in A.A.	29,340
Young People and A.A.	44,106
A.A. for the Woman	42,343
A.A. Tradition - How it Developed.....	21,999
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	31,834
Alcoholism the Illness	52,439
The Alcoholic Husband	57,728
The Alcoholic Wife	39,697
The Alcoholic Employee	24,631
A.A. & The Medical Profession	35,719
A.A. Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism.....	58,996
Tranquilizers, Sedatives & the Alcoholic	48,208
Saturday Evening Post Reprint.....	38,023
Fortune Reprint	26,008

Good Housekeeping Reprint	34,330
Inside A.A.	20,461
The Third Legacy Manual	6,402
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	45,764
The Fellowship of A.A.	49,752
Memo to an Inmate	25,178
G.S.R. Folder	29,000
Foreign Translations	36,956
Total Pamphlets Shipped	1,138,115

MISCELLANEOUS

Wallet Cards.....	242,243
Parchment Scrolls.....	1,703
How it Works (Excerpt from Big Book).....	25,059

For the first time the total pamphlets shipped exceeded 1,000,000 in a single year.

As part of its publishing operation, A.A.W.S. is distributing the new G.S.O. filmstrip. The filmstrip, together with a record, make up a set which retails for \$4.50. Also new in 1962 was the *descriptive order form* which presented Conference-approved books and pamphlets, with brief descriptions of each, grouped according to their use.

SHIPPING: As G.S.O. activities increase and as the distribution of books and pamphlets mounts each year, the Shipping Department gets busier and busier. In 1962 it handled 51,614 pieces of incoming mail and was responsible for 218,000 outgoing items, including more than 70,000 pieces of mail and the group "Exchange Bulletin." It wrapped and shipped 35,051 packages. Al Cryan supervises six full-time and two part-time employees.

G. S. B. Nominating Committee

(Sumner C., Chairman)

The Nominating Committee of the General Service Board met quarterly during the past year. Their activities involved the implementing of the recommendations of the 1962 General Service Conference to increase the membership of the General Service Board of Trustees by two non-A.A.'s (Class A) and two A.A. (Class B) members. The Conference Committee on Trustees was kept advised and worked closely with the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board during the year, offering suggestions and approval of all actions.

These actions included, —

1. Acceptance of the recommendation of the subcommittee on Electoral Procedures, whose Chairman was Tom S. to allocate six regions in the United States for the purpose of electing future Regional Class B Trustees. The Regions — Pacific, Southwest, West Central, East Central, Southeast and Northeast.
2. A Regional rotation plan wherein each region elects a Trustee every six years was established. To get this procedure rolling, the Southwest Region agreed to have their '63 Trustee serve for two years.
3. All Delegates, Committee Members and groups in Pacific, Southwest, and East Central Regions were advised of their eligibility to present a candidate from each state for possible election as a Class B Trustee in April of 1963. Suggested qualifications as to business or professional experience and ten years of A.A. sobriety accompanied this mailing. Delegates were requested to use the Third Legacy procedure and to submit the name of their candidate by January 15.
4. All proposed candidates and the procedure followed in their election were reviewed by the Nominating Committee of the Board at their January meeting and it was noted that the Third Legacy procedure had been followed in all cases. The State of Nevada did not submit a candidate. The State of Illinois submitted two candidates. The candidates chosen by two of the three Conference Areas in Illinois, was selected by the Nominating Committee.
5. A procedure was prepared for the joint meeting of the Nominating Committee of the Board, the Trustees Committee of the Conference and the current regional Delegates to be held during the Conference for the election of one Class B Trustee Nominee from each region. It was distributed to Delegates and candidates involved in the election.
6. Resumes of all candidates from their region were forwarded to Delegates and also to the candidates themselves.

7. Puerto Rico was included in the Southeast Region.
8. The Nominating Committee examined its composition, scope and procedures, and prepared a written program which secured Board approval. This program, which is subject to reaffirmation by the Board each year, provides for (a) suitable representation on the Committees of the Board and its entities; (b) responsibilities of the Committee in the nominations of Trustees, Directors of A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the appointment of Staff Members; and (c) specific steps to be taken in the consideration of such nominations and appointments.
9. Approved the nomination of five Grapevine Corporate Board Directors: Lee B., Yvelin G., Jay J., Charles L., and Gurney W. and two A.A.W.S. Directors: Dick M. and Bob K. for election to those two boards.
10. Considered the General Service Board needs re two new Class A Trustees and recommended Dr. Harvey Cruickshank and Judge John M. Murtagh.
11. Submit the following as nominees for Class A and Class B Trustees to be elected at the Annual Meeting of the General Service Board to be held on April 29, 1963 — subject to approval of the Conference.

Class A Trustees

Leonard V. Harrison
Austin H. McCormick
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
Harrison M. Trice
L. Ivan Underwood
Dr. Harvey Cruickshank
Judge John M. Murtagh

Class B Trustees

Allan B.
David B.
Mary B.
Don G.
Thomas S.
Eugene K.

The Nominating Committee also nominated the following as officers of the G.S.B., to be elected at the April quarterly Board meeting which will follow the annual meeting on April 29, 1963.

Chairman — Dr. John L. Norris
1st Vice-Chairman — Bernard B. Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman — Allan B.
Secretary — Eugene K.
Treasurer — Archibald B. Roosevelt

INSTITUTIONAL A.A. MEMBERS SHOWING INCREASED INTEREST IN CONFERENCE

For a number of years there have been growing indications that A.A. groups in correctional institutions and hospitals are becoming increasingly aware of the General Service structure of the Society, and interested in participating in it.

A discussion session at the 1963 Conference focussed on this development and revealed that a number of Areas have already taken steps to bring institutional A.A. into the Conference picture. In some places, representatives of prison groups have been permitted to attend Area Assemblies, following which they have reported back to their groups. In other Areas, Delegates have made it a specific responsibility to

visit institutions to report on Conference activity to "inside" groups. In one Canadian province, Saskatchewan, prison groups have become actively interested in General Service activity by assuming responsibility for certain categories of printed materials used in their Area.

Midge M. of the G.S.O. Staff reported that a continuing study is underway to determine: (1) If institutional groups are encouraged to have G.S.R.'s (2) If so, how G.S.R.'s are elected and (3) The extent to which institutional group G.S.R.'s participate in Assemblies and report back to their groups.

The "A.A. Exchange Bulletin"

The "Bulletin" strives to incorporate news about A.A. services as performed at G.S.O. However, if an item of A.A. news reaches G.S.O. that has universal interest or application, it is shared via the "Exchange Bulletin," though it might not relate directly to G.S.O. services. The present Bulletin printing is 17,000 copies.

In 1963, there will be eight issues of the "Bulletin," March is omitted, as it is the month devoted to the spring Appeal Letter. The Conference Digest has always replaced the June issue. *July and August* issues are to be combined, as are those for *September and October*. (The fall Appeal Letter will be mailed with the *September and October* combined issue. If this new schedule is agreeable to the groups, it will be continued.)

Financial Report

(Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer, G.S.B.)

Operations of A.A.'s General Services resulted in a net income of \$9,561 in 1962 as compared with a net income of \$8,708 in 1961. (Exclusive of Reserve Fund appreciation.)

The publishing activities of A.A. World Services, Inc. earned \$56,625.

Group Contributions in 1962 were \$256,015. The 1962 contributions were \$15,983 below the cost of Office and Conference expenses and the sum of \$16,000 was transferred from the General Fund to the Group Fund to make up this deficit. Contributions were \$3,855 short of the estimated budgeted expenses. Our actual operating expenses were approximately 4½% over the budget expenses.

The Reserve Fund had added to it in 1962 \$27,016 in book discounts donated and in investment income.

SUGGESTED SHARE OF 1963 BUDGET

Based on an estimated budget of \$279,240 and on the 1962 membership, the share of each state and province for the year 1963 is apportioned in the following schedule.

U.S.	1962 Membership	State or Province Share
Alabama.....	973	\$ 2,075
Alaska	265	565
Arizona	952	2,030
Arkansas	706	1,505
California.....	20,949	44,645
Colorado	1,248	2,660
Connecticut	2,038	4,345
Delaware	289	615
District of Columbia	776	1,655
Florida	3,775	8,045
Georgia	1,355	2,890
Hawaii.....	316	675
Idaho	355	755
Illinois	8,650	18,435
Indiana	2,135	4,550
Iowa	1,575	3,335
Kansas	1,365	2,900
Kentucky	900	1,915
Louisiana	1,600	3,410
Maine	470	1,000
Maryland	1,426	3,040
Massachusetts	3,375	7,195
Michigan	5,200	11,080
Minnesota	4,344	9,255
Mississippi	642	1,370
Missouri.....	2,360	5,030
Montana	540	1,155
Nebraska	590	1,260
Nevada	600	1,280
New Hampshire	320	685
New Jersey	2,914	6,210
New Mexico	650	1,385
New York	8,725	18,590
North Carolina	2,220	4,730
North Dakota	500	1,065

U.S.	1962 Membership	State or Province Share
Ohio	8,100	17,255
Oklahoma	1,420	3,025
Oregon	1,010	2,155
Pennsylvania	4,345	9,260
Rhode Island	235	505
South Carolina	900	1,915
South Dakota	735	1,565
Tennessee	790	1,680
Texas	6,636	14,140
Utah	750	1,600
Vermont	336	715
Virginia	2,138	4,555
Washington	2,224	4,740
West Virginia	570	1,210
Wisconsin	2,039	4,345
Wyoming	227	485
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	400	850
Total for U.S.	117,953	\$251,355

CANADA

Alberta	981	2,090
British Columbia	1,954	4,150
Manitoba	918	1,955
New Brunswick	506	1,075
Newfoundland	118	250
Nova Scotia	600	1,280
Ontario	4,317	9,200
Prince Edward Island	184	395
Quebec	2,605	5,550
Saskatchewan	874	1,860
Yukon Territory	23	50
Northwest Territories	13	30
Total for Canada	13,093	\$27,885
Total for U.S. & CANADA	131,046	\$279,240

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS" PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

The 1963 Conference followed the precedent established in 1962 when more than 40 Area Delegates were invited to give brief presentations on the development of the Fellowship in their Areas.

The talks were programmed to illuminate three main points: (1) How A.A. is progressing in an Area; (2) Area problems and how they are being solved, and (3) What is being done to stimulate interest in A.A.'s General Services.

Condensations of the talks follow:

SO. CALIFORNIA (Panel 1) Clyde D.

Group growth: First group formed in December, 1939; 314 groups in December, 1962. Sobriety: Ten years (and longer) birthdays common; majority of members staying sober and active. "Carrying the message:" Usual Twelfth Step work, beginners' meetings, open meetings, A.A. speakers at outside groups, G.S.O. national publicity. Area problems: Anonymity breaks: "Remind those concerned of Traditions." Official old-timers: "Recommend study of A.A. books and pamphlets." We stimulate interest in General Services through special G.S.O. information meetings, use of filmstrip, Assemblies open to members, recommended reading of Third Legacy and Twelve Concepts material and The A.A. Grapevine.

KANSAS — Paul M.

Efforts of the incumbent Kansas Committee has been focused on "informing" its G.S.R.'s as to who and what they are. The Committee feels that progress is being made, problems are being solved or avoided and interest in all things A.A. is being stimulated through information. As the G.S.R. is designated the group's Information Center, the G.S.R. should be appropriately informed. The State Committee is attempting to accomplish this through G.S.R. Sectional Meetings. The results have been most encouraging.

SO. MINNESOTA — Joe W.

Have started a series of joint group meetings throughout Area, showing G.S.O. filmstrips. Past and present Delegates taking part to familiarize everyone with importance of General Service and to encourage everyone to feel they are an important part of its function. Each group in Area can trace its existence to the Big Book Pat C. found in the library, which would not have been there except for G.S.O.

OREGON — Bruce W.

Reports overall unity and activity result in good growth. Analysis of variety of new members shows that the A.A. message is reaching out to all classes. An effective and well accepted Area Committee has been able to handle all problems that come up. General Service activity is still growing and G.S.O. help and the recent filmstrip are credited with a lot of success. A newsletter has also helped bring good results.

ALASKA — Vic K.

A.A. in Alaska is growing slowly but surely. New groups are being formed throughout the State, and we are confident that as our population increases, so will our Fellowship. The advent of local committees on alcoholism has been a great help to A.A. The North Conway Foundation Seminar held in Sitka in 1962 provided the incentive for formation of these Committees, and A.A. is reaping the benefits. State Assemblies, World Service workshops and educational material are all having their influence on the membership's interest in A.A. on the national and world-wide level. Our problems of distance and communication are gradually being overcome and the future of Alcoholics Anonymous in Alaska shines brightly.

BRITISH COLUMBIA (Yukon) Jim W.

Growth, increased interest and lack of problems must be credited to our past Delegate, Jo W. Her willingness, dedication and tactfulness were reflected throughout the Area. Several factors were responsible:

1. A fine Delegate keeping us informed.
2. Frequent G.S.R. meetings,

3. Urban areas creating teams of G.S.R.'s captained by a Committee member,
4. G.S.R.'s speaking once a month on World Service,
5. Committee members visiting groups in their team frequently, and
6. Interest created by the filmstrip.

WASHINGTON — Everett K.

Communication, the number one problem in this sprawling state of 68,192 square miles, has received a big assist with the formation of the Greyhound Group. Eighty per cent of Washington's A.A. population is concentrated west of the Cascade Mountains. Thirty-eight "Greyhounds" visiting widely scattered groups bring new faces and new voices carrying the miracle message that A.A. works. Unity in the ranks of Washington A.A. is at a new high.

SO. CALIFORNIA (San Diego) Fritz H.

A.A. in the San Diego area has grown from a small beginning in 1940 to over 1,500 hard-core members in 1963. About 30% of the membership attend three or more of the 72 regularly scheduled meetings each week. Area problems are minor and primarily of a financial nature. General Service promoted at central meeting and by distribution of literature.

SOUTHEASTERN MICHIGAN — Edith M.

A.A. membership in Southeastern Michigan is increasing tremendously. Institutional programs are operating successfully. Relations with outside agencies are excellent. There has been discord among some of our groups but, one step at a time, we are approaching unity through recourse to the group conscience. We find that by keeping members informed of G.S.O. happenings, interest in General Service is stimulated and our people feel that they have a voice in the workings of our wonderful Fellowship.

WESTERN MASSACHUSETTS — Clarence M.

We have an increase in the number of small groups which show growth, but our larger groups have grown smaller. We have the feeling that A.A. in our Area is not growing in pace with the growth of alcoholism as a disease. We also would like to stimulate older members to increased activity.

These problems have not been solved on an Area-wide basis.

We have been stimulating interest in General Services through filmstrips and an active General Service Assembly.

NORTHWEST TEXAS — Tom H.

Our pressing problem now is the failure of new people to stay with the program and to continue to come to the meetings, they are "passing through." The solution of course is better sponsorship — which must come from the active membership — and more education, which comes from Al-Anon and from the information center which is being formed. Our counselors in the State Hospitals and penal institutions are also doing a most wonderful job in rehabilitating the alcoholic.

Since the beginning of A.A. in our Area in 1945 we now have 35 groups and about 1500 members. Our growth is good both in percentage and numerically, and is increasing yearly.

At "Delegate's report meeting" in the Area, the G.S.O. filmstrip was shown. The consensus: "This is the best presentation about G.S.O. for both new and old members, and for visitors, we have ever seen."

MANITOBA, CANADA — Bill C.

There are 41 groups in Manitoba. Group problems are kept to a minimum through the almost exclusive use of Conference-approved literature. This makes for active and happy groups, whose members, by using approved A.A. literature, become aware of A.A. philosophy and seek to follow this wonderful way of life.

We have found that a written report on the New York Conference by the Delegate to all G.S.R.'s is important and helpful. My report on the Conference and a copy of the talk from the G.S.O. filmstrip were sent to all G.S.R.'s in Manitoba. This means that the story of G.S.O. reaches those who are unable to hear the Delegate in person.

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS" PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

SO. FLORIDA — Bob R.

The past two years were spent in overcoming the apathy of groups in this area toward the General Service Office. The present committee meetings have been attended by Committee Members from all of the districts that comprise the South Florida Conference, plus many General Service Representative and group members. We take this as a good omen for "Our Common Welfare" and our Area's continued growth.

HAWAII — Ben S.

A.A. in Hawaii has progressed substantially since 1956. Twenty-one additional groups have been activated. Groups have suffered little mortality. Area problems of cohesive united effort, sponsorship weakness, inadequate answering service, permanent secretaries, and overlapping of functions are being corrected by a strong and active G.S.R. and a functioning, intelligent Inter-Group. Hawaii's G.S.R.'s are active and enthusiastic. Groups have shown increased interest and cooperation. Continued healthy growth for 1963-64 is indicated.

NEVADA — Kathryn A.

The number of our groups has increased remarkably. Hospital and institutional work is well received. Cooperation from public officials is excellent in helping slippers who find our 24-hour drinking hours a menace to their sobriety. Our only problems are the pill-users and the old-timer who fails to attend meetings. Educational talks in high schools have been numerous and most effective. Much genuine interest in G.S.O. has been activated through the election of strong, solid General Service Representatives.

N.W. OHIO AND S.E. MICHIGAN — Roy D.

Our membership IS growing. We have G.S.R.'s in all groups and they and the (non-voting) Delegates, ex-officio, actively participate at our meetings. Group contributions to G.S.O. have improved. We were host to a very successful State Conference last year. Our very active Inter-Group Association has a new Central Office location with better facilities. Our Central Office Secretary is a lady member of Al-Anon. We offer this ABC theme for General Service: "Let's Always Be Cooperatingly Dedicated in Service."

WESTERN NEW YORK — Maynard A.

Group-wise — over the past five years there has been measurable growth. Some groups have faded away but the deaths have been exceeded by the births. We have gone, in recent years, from 700 to 800 groups, with membership growing at about the same rate — 10 to 12%. We now have groups that hold their meetings in the daytime for the benefit of night-shift workers. Five years ago there was one such group in this area. Now there are four. Other types of groups which have developed within the past few years are those in institutions — either correctional or hospital and sanatorium.

Our first problem is non-support — either fiscal or physical of the group, the Central office or G.S.O. With respect to physical non-support — non-meeting attendance or non-participation in Central Office and General Service activities — we counter this by making meetings and activities more attractive — even essential. We are stimulating interest in General Service with the G.S.O. filmstrip — one of the most useful services ever provided.

CONNECTICUT — Frank J.

The old and new Committees working together are determined to further favorable recognition of A.A. in Connecticut.

Public information activities have created much interest among service clubs, welfare and health agencies, church organizations, educators and others. Participation in a county health fair, a State Police program against drunken driving, a radio program sponsored for public information and a successful State Convention are among last year's activities. Closer state A.A. unity and quarterly G.S.R. meetings are part of this year's agenda.

LOUISIANA — Hope S.

Harmonious relations among groups result from Louisiana State Assembly meetings that are held three or four times a year. Members receive insight as to Area problems, how they are handled, and close association of G.S.O. activities. Interest has been stimulated by the G.S.O. film. Individuals say that they now have better understanding of how group fund contributions to G.S.O. are used. The functioning of this Assembly has helped accelerate the growth of A.A. in Louisiana.

ATLANTIC PROVINCES, CANADA — Jack M.

The four Atlantic Provinces, exclusive of Labrador, cover a land surface of 207,422 miles. Travel conditions between the mainland and the island provinces are uncertain by air and hazardous by road in winter and spring. Distance and isolation are the greatest deterrents to unity and progress. We hope to solve these problems by holding separate provincial conferences at which the Delegate will give his report. We are also trying to form smaller committees to accelerate dissemination of information and provide better liaison. The G.S.O. filmstrip can be shown at provincial conferences and then released for district showings by Committeemen.

MONTANA — Ed G.

Growth in members, groups, and contributions tell us A.A. is progressing in Montana. The problems we have, such as communications, operation of club houses, and following our Traditions when cooperating with outside agencies, we believe can, and will, be solved with time and maturity.

Interest in G.S.O. is being stimulated by the G.S.O. filmstrip, subscribing to and reading "The Grapevine," and by the Delegate's report, putting emphasis on the tremendous amount of work being done by everyone connected with G.S.O.

RHODE ISLAND — Irving F.

The progress of A.A. in Rhode Island is on the move in a large way. One can sense this by the increasing numbers of young people attending A.A. meetings. There are many A.A. members that either belong to several groups or do not wish to be associated with any particular group. Therefore it is difficult to give a true count of A.A. membership. The problem of endorsement and affiliation by outside agencies was largely overcome by meeting with these agencies and explaining our Traditions.

TENNESSEE — Dennis M.

As do most groups, we in the Chattanooga Area have our problems, such as clubroom activities, but usually work them out. Recently we had an "old-timers" banquet and also a city-wide open meeting with Al B. of Dallas as speaker. We are cooperating with the State of Tennessee on a rehabilitation program being set up to help the sick alcoholic find a better way of life such as we have found.

SOUTHWEST OHIO — Harold R.

First Delegate elected in 1958. Area Committee formed and expanded to cover entire area. Was Host Area for Ohio State General Service Conference in July, 1959, which helped the growth and general activity of the Area. We have strengthened our Committeemen and G.S.R.'s by having reports and information given to the groups through them. Through the Area Committee, we have had additional group activity and cooperation with other agencies. Also increased Al-Anon and Alateen growth.

UTAH — Bill C.

Progress favorable, with active working committees and cooperation of outside agencies. One problem is lack of knowledge regarding local, state and world services, which creates boredom and disinterest with new as well as older members. Lack of group unity and group complacency also require some attention.

Programs on such topics as the Three Legacies, A.A.'s structure, the Twelve Concepts and the Traditions have been set up for group discussion. Interest in G.S.O. is helped by discussions and by films and literature questionnaires regarding general services being forwarded to all groups. Summaries of answers received will be sent to groups.

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS" PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

INDIANA — Bill G.

A.A. is progressing satisfactorily in our state. Several new groups have been started in the past year. Indiana saw a need for a convention in the Southwestern part of the state in addition to the State Convention. This was a success, as 60% of the audience had never attended one before. Area problems consist of keeping older members' attendance, informing the public of our existence and advising groups of the G.S.O.'s work. Our goal is to help those who still suffer.

COLORADO — Floyd P.

The annual State Conference, four years old this year, is giving A.A. the biggest shot in the arm. More and better results are anticipated.

Regional, or District, meetings sponsored by the State Committee are doing much toward stimulating interest in General Services.

Communication between groups on a State-wide basis is a problem. We hope to overcome some of this by bringing the G.S.R.'s to District Meetings, rather than have the Delegate try to visit all the groups, which are so far apart in Colorado.

ILLINOIS (Downstate) — Carl S.

Conferences of both Southern & Northern Sections were held shortly after the last General Service Conference. Elimination of conflict resulted in the re-activation of two groups. Downstate Fall Conference was held at Peoria, unanimously electing Ed C. new G.S.C. Delegate. Fifth Area monthly breakfast meeting continues to be stimulating. Meeting in December selected Ward M. of Springfield as Illinois Candidate for nomination for Class B Trustee for East Central Region.

EASTERN MISSOURI — Al S.

A.A. is continuing to spread in our area with new groups. We have noted a special growth in Correctional Groups. Taking an active interest in our fellow man and in neighboring groups, who have the same problems we have, eliminates a lot of our differences.

WESTERN PENNSYLVANIA — Glenn W.

We have been most fortunate in developing a good solid quality of A.A., and a wide acceptance and improved understanding of what A.A. is and is not. We have a fine working relationship with clergymen, doctors, press, radio, television, alcoholism agencies and industry in our Area. We have made it a practice to invite interested nonalcoholics to our open meetings. Each year we receive — and fill — more requests to furnish speakers for church, civic, professional and other groups. Remarkable interest in General Services has been stimulated in various ways. In the Erie Area we hold a G.S.R. breakfast the first Sunday of each month, open to all interested A.A. members; another interest stimulator is to call on the G.S.R. at regular group meetings for any report he may have, including items of interest from the "Exchange Bulletin."

WYOMING — Mauritz K.

Wyoming has a greater number of groups now. Hospitals and prisons do have A.A. program, the Indians on the Wind River Reservation have started a group, a normal splitting has brought some groups into small towns about the state, state conferences have shown an increase in physical activity, more members attend. Doctors, lawyers, judges, and the mental health groups show less reluctance in recommending A.A.

Possibly the only Area problem in Wyoming is distance, but slowly intergroup affairs are tending to "generalize" Areas and promote the willingness to associate ideas and welfare by increasing the local attendance in each area periodically.

NORTHERN CALIFORNIA — Cliff J.

A.A. is progressing in our Area, and not in spite of local problems, but because of them. Progress gives birth to problems demanding solutions. Our satisfactory and effective solutions have necessitated a meeting of minds in the area of experience and stability with our vital new enthusiasm and fresh approaches. This blending of old and new, breeds an atmosphere of basic unity and common goals, and makes it possible for us to carry the vital message of General Service more effectively to the open minds and listening ears that are evident all over our Area.

QUEBEC, CANADA — Rollie D.

The events of major importance during the past few years in the Province of Quebec have been the tremendous expansion of A.A. from the Cities into the "grassroots" predominantly where English is neither understood nor spoken; the reactivation of the Q.P.G.S.; the translating, printing and distributing of all G.S. material into French, finally establishing a communicable basis with our French Canadian brothers and finally the translation, printing and publishing of the Big Book in French.

WESTERN MICHIGAN — Austin D.

(At the request of G.S.O., Austin, who had not been scheduled to present an Area Highlight, reported on a survey of G.S.R. activity in his Area.) Fifty-seven groups were polled, 20 responded. All had G.S.R.'s but the scope of the Representatives' knowledge of Conference structure, and the degree of activity, varied sharply. While all G.S.R.'s reported that they kept their groups informed of new G.S.O. literature, 17 reported they had never corresponded with G.S.O.

NEW YORK (Mohawk-Hudson) Ivar J.

Five new groups acquired representation on the Area Committee during the past year and all groups are building on a firm foundation. A new Institutional Committee has recently been formed. Normal problems of attendance, programming and financing require special effort at times. Relations with outside organizations are generally good. Interest in General Services is being stimulated by use of the new G.S.O. filmstrip, but it seems doubtful that any "great" interest can be generated in the near future.

SOUTHERN WISCONSIN — Douglas McC.

Area A.A. is headed into a period of revitalization. Two conferences are held each year, in the Eastern and Western parts of Southern Wisconsin. In the fall of 1962, a Secretaries Group was formed to "stimulate contacts involving all members of A.A." Membership in the Milwaukee Area increased about 10 per cent during the past year and new group formations have kept pace. A.A. has been welcomed into three new institutions. A major problem is to maintain contact with inactive members; continuous mailings are being used.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA — Buck D.

Interest in A.A. in the District is accelerating. The most recent annual banquet attracted 1,400 persons. While there is some reluctance to welcome descriptions of General Service, progress is being made in creating better understanding of what the services can mean to the Fellowship. "We work on the idea that there are at least a few members in each group who are interested."

NORTHERN CALIFORNIA (Coastal Panel #1) — Bill G.

Much progress has been made, primarily due to the cooperation between the Intergroup Office (Northern California Council) and the General Service Committee. Awareness of the importance of A.A.'s worldwide services is growing; the main concern has been to keep open lines of communication between the groups and G.S.O. Special steps have been taken in recent years to keep districts small, to permit better coverage. "The new G.S.O. filmstrip has done more than anything else recently to stimulate interest in General Service."

VIRGINIA — Francis L.

The number of groups is increasing in the Area and it has been necessary to add three additional Committee Members during the past year. Work with A.A. members in prisons and hospitals has contributed to "carrying the message" throughout the territory. Progress also can be reported in helping doctors to appreciate how A.A. can assist alcoholics.

ARKANSAS — Mooring H.

There are now 57 groups in the state, with two more due to be registered at G.S.O. in the near future. Registered membership is 706. A total of 675 persons registered for the State Convention in 1962. Area problems are similar to those encountered elsewhere in A.A. More Intergroup meetings "will answer most of our troubles." Stimulating support of General Service is a problem but progress is being made in this field.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

As in the past, all Delegates had an opportunity to obtain specific information — anonymously, if desired — by placing questions in a special container, the "Ask-It-Basket." Following are answers to 1963 questions of movement-wide interest.

1. Can anyone suggest a tactful method of removing a welfare worker who insists on attending and supervising closed A.A. meetings in a local state hospital?

Several Delegates commented on this problem on the basis of experience in their Areas. They noted that a direct approach (to a welfare worker or an institutional superintendent) could be effective in making it clear that A.A. closed meetings are most helpful when they are limited to alcoholics.

2. Where an Area has both a Central Committee and an Area Committee, what should be done in case of conflict? Which controls?

It was observed by a Southern California Delegate and by others that neither "controls" — both Committees try to serve. "They should confer with G.S.O. and other Boards to determine what is right, in what area each should serve."

3. How do groups in the South handle the integration problem?

While there was no extended discussion of this question, the Delegate from South Carolina pointed out that no A.A. members would be excluded from the Columbia, South Carolina hotel where the Sixth Annual Young People's Conference will be held this Spring.

APPROVED LITERATURE

4. Why is the use of A.A.-approved literature recommended?

Conference-approved literature means that this literature has been reviewed by the G.S.O. and G.S.C. Literature Committees, and that Delegates have agreed that this literature reflects the opinions of A.A. as a whole.

5. Will a pocket edition of the "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" lessen the profits on the sale of the larger books? Or will the over-all advantage be better?

The proposed pocket edition was considered in some detail, but tabled for possible further consideration in 1964.

6. How can we handle a bossy person who is disturbing a group?

Western New York Delegate thought the only way was to read the Serenity Prayer! It was noted by several Delegates that everyone was guilty at some time or other on this point.

7. Workers for the Red Cross and other major charitable groups are permitted to claim income tax deductions for the expenses they thus entail. Have any steps been taken, or are any planned, to permit A.A.'s on Area Committees engaged in World Service activities the right to take such expenses as tax deductions?

In replying to this question, the independent certified public accountant serving G.S.O. commented as follows: "Such expenses would seem to qualify for deduction as contributions. The following is quoted from Income Tax Regulation 1.170-2(a) (2): 'Unreimbursed expenditures made incident to the rendition of services to an organization contributions to which are deductible may constitute a deductible contribution. Out-of-pocket transportation expenses necessarily incurred in rendering donated services are deductible. Reasonable expenditures for meals and lodging necessarily incurred while away from home in the course of rendering donated services are also deductible.' In this activity, the organization contributions to which are deductible would be the General Service Board of A.A., Inc."

8. Is there a possibility of compiling an "A.A.-approved" study book on the Twelve Steps?

Several Areas expressed interest in this, wanting to make a breakdown of the Twelve Steps into small units, particularly for work with new people. Idea is becoming popular. Referred to Literature Committee.

9. Can Bill W.'s Recommendations, as now included in material relating to the Twelve Concepts, be published separately and given wider circulation?

It was pointed out that Bill's "Recommendations," together with the "Trustees' Comments and Recommendations," have been published and are available on request.

10. Please discuss the problems of women in A.A.

The main problem seems to be one of communication. When a woman is the only one in a group where rest are men, she often is unable to express her thoughts freely and openly. Feeling was that a woman's group provided opportunity for sharing of problems not possible in a group composed mainly of men. Staff Member said sponsorship of women through correspondence is planned.

11. Why can't topics for G.S.O. Conference discussion be forwarded to Delegates at least three months or more in advance? It is difficult to get opinion of Area on short notice.

G.S.O. will try to start earlier on Conference preparations where it is possible to do so.

12. Could the word "Conference" be restricted in general usage to mean only the Annual General Service Conference, and word "Assembly" reserved for State or Provincial meetings having to do with World Service purposes only? (This will avoid confusion with local conferences and place more importance on World Service.)

It would be difficult to get Areas to differentiate meaning. Once a word comes into general usage, it is hard to change. Actually, the New York meeting is not "the Conference"; it is the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of A.A.

ADMISSIONS COMMITTEE

13. The Admissions Committee agreed that Chicago should elect a single Delegate, otherwise none would be seated. The G.S.O. advised one "faction" that it could send its man if desired. Who gives a G.S.O. secretary authority to over-rule Admissions Committee?

Question is based on a misunderstanding of the facts. Problem was presented to members of Admissions Committee, (who responded unanimously), their thinking being that this matter should be settled locally through election of a single Delegate. Letters were written to everyone concerned, informing them of Admissions Committee thinking.

14. Could a pamphlet on duties of G.S.R. be published?

There is one and it has been mailed out. The G.S. Office has a supply on hand and will be glad to send them out upon request. If there are any suggestions for change, please advise G.S.O.

15. Could a condensed "Guide to the Study of the Twelve Steps" be prepared?

Referred to Literature Committee.

16. Suggestion for change of name for "Partners in A.A.": "How the Group Starts and How it Grows."

The Delegates approved changing the name of the "Partners" pamphlet to "The Group Handbook — How the A.A. Group Starts and Grows." The change will be effective with the next revision of the pamphlet.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

17. Can G.S.O. make available a pamphlet with brief biographical material on G.S.B. Trustees?

This material appears in the Conference Report each year. It also is available at G.S.O. in mimeograph form.

18. Is it practical (or advisable) for G.S.O. to maintain a listing of speakers which might be used in planning Area conferences and conventions?

G.S.O. shares information on speakers but does not attempt to "evaluate" them. The Staff suggests that Area Committees and Central Offices can share speaker information with each other. It was also pointed out that many meetings are taped and that Conference committees may use such tapes as source of speaker material.

CONTRIBUTION 'LOYALTY'

19. What can be done when a Central Committee advises local groups that their first "contribution" loyalty is to the Central Committee and then to G.S.O.?

The Conference indicated this was a matter of communication and "education." It was suggested that the new filmstrip on General Services can be helpful. One Delegate asks his groups to think in terms "of the total need."

20. By what authority was a recent bulletin on Intergroup operations issued without Conference approval?

It developed that the question was based on a misunderstanding. It was explained that many types of service material have traditionally been released without specific approval by the Conference, not Conference-approved in the usual sense. The G.S.O., to serve the movement, must have freedom to provide service literature, it was pointed out.

21. What can be done to maintain active interest of Committee Members who live at the extreme ends of "long" Areas?

Experience reported included: (1) Allowing districts to volunteer as hosts for quarterly meetings; (2) Arranging regional meetings within the Area; (3) Making more effective use of Area Committee Members and G.S.R.'s; (4) Using G.S.O. filmstrip to stimulate interest in General Service; (5) Encouraging participation through efficient distribution of meeting minutes and related material.

22. Why was the A.A. symbol left off the "Twelve Concepts" manual?

This was an oversight and will be corrected in the next printing.

23. What was the distribution pattern for the film, "Faith for Today"?

There is no pattern. Copies are available at G.S.O. and can be sent to Delegates and Committee Members on request.

24. What is the difference between "alcoholism the illness" and "alcoholism the disease"?

Most A.A.'s regard the difference as one of degree, although - medically speaking - there is a sharper distinction. (Dr. John L. Norris)

25. Can we use stronger measures to point out to doctors the "menace" pills hold for an alcoholic?

It was agreed the best approach was the long-term one of letting doctors know of the specific experience of alcoholics who have used pills.

26. What were the results, if any, of the meeting involving the G.S.B. Public Information Committee and representatives of the Pentagon?

There has been no such meeting, but we continue to be interested in making our help available to alcoholics in the armed forces, upon request.

27. Why can't we hold the General Service Conference every two years instead of annually, to save expense?

It would be difficult for the Conference to handle all the matters that would accumulate over a two-year period. Also, G.S.O. relies on the advisory actions of Conferences, and should have access to Conference guidance on an annual basis.

28. What, if anything, can be done about a member who has been hired by a church organization as a lecturer on alcoholism, referring to his personal experience in A.A.?

It was agreed this was a matter for local autonomy.

29. What is a good answer to the new member who asks if it is necessary to affiliate with a group?

The questioner was referred to the sponsorship discussion at the "Table Topics" session.

30. Is taking a collection at a "public meeting" of A.A. a violation of A.A. Tradition?

Yes it was felt by most of the Delegates that this would be a violation.

31. To what extent should A.A. podiums be made available to speakers from other agencies?

It was agreed this was a matter of local autonomy.

32. Would it be practical to have the District Committee Member present the customary free literature package to a newly-registered group?

This procedure does not appear to be practical on a broad basis. However, G.S.O. will explore various suggestions designed to create friendly relationships between a new group and an Area Delegate.

33. Has thought been given to moving G.S.O. into a more centrally located Area, such as the Midwest?

The matter has been considered, but a move of this type would create many problems. "It is a question of being located centrally in relation to A.A. throughout the world, not just in the U.S. and Canada."

34. Do Delegates feel there could be an improvement in the G.S.O. filmstrip presentation? Equipment for showing it is not always available in my Area. "Synchronization is always breaking down." Has thought been given to possible preparation of an 8mm silent film?

No Delegates commented on this question. It was pointed out by a Staff member that the filmstrip technique is less expensive than using slides, that there have been no other complaints on synchronization and that projectors are generally available from many sources in a community, including schools, churches and automobile dealers. Production of a silent film on G.S.O. operations has been considered in the past but nothing is under consideration at the moment, pending review of the usefulness of the new filmstrip.

NARCOTIC USERS

35. In several prisons, narcotics users constitute a large percentage of the A.A. membership. What can be done to discourage narcotics addicts from assuming positions of leadership in inmate A.A. group activities?

Reference was made to Bill's article, "Problems Other Than Alcohol," in the February, 1958 Grapevine. In general, it was felt that narcotics addicts are welcome at A.A. meetings but traditionally do not participate or "hold office" unless they qualify as alcoholics.

36. Does the use of meeting announcements in the press or on radio or television conform to A.A. Tradition?

It was felt that such announcements do not constitute promotion or any violation of A.A. Tradition.

37. What determines a member's classification as a Loner?

Geographical factors, primarily, but also such factors as physical handicaps.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

38. What kind of leadership is sanctioned in A.A.?

This question is answered in some detail in "The Twelve Concepts" and in material on A.A. Tradition. In A.A. leadership is inextricably identified with service.

39. Is information available on groups with special programs to attract and hold the interest of old-timers?

This question was answered in large part in the Conference presentation on "Our Common Welfare." Material also appears in the "Exchange Bulletin."

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

40. What are the duties and responsibilities of Delegates in relation to local conventions and Assemblies?

In one Area, there are three local Assemblies, where one Delegate serves as chairman and all Committee Members attend. The Delegate explained that there is no formal relationship with local conventions, but there is cooperation.

41. Can the A.A. professional exhibit be used at a state fair?

The exhibit has been approved for use only in connection with professional meetings and exceptions to this authorization have been permitted only in very special circumstances.

42. Is it advisable to limit speakers at A.A. meetings, to permit increased participation?

It was agreed this was a matter of local autonomy.

43. Why aren't the questions that are directed to New York from various groups sent to the appropriate Delegates who, in turn, can refer them to Committee Members and G.S.O.'s for personal follow-up?

All "serious" questions are referred to Delegates in the Area concerned. G.S.O. will review procedures, to assure that they are as helpful to Delegates as possible.

44. Could an annual "memorial day" commemorating deceased members be established?

The sense of the Conference was that a memorial day would not be appropriate, that November as "Gratitude Month" suffices.

45. Should an Area Delegate serve on the Board of Directors of a rehabilitation home originally established by A.A.'s as a Twelfth Step House, but now tax-supported?

Traditionally, any member of A.A. may serve an outside facility as long as it is clear that he does not represent A.A. in any way and serves as an individual only.

46. There is a tendency to refer to a vague "they" when describing service actions taken in A.A. Shouldn't we explore ways of emphasizing that all actions are the product of a collective "we"?

It was suggested that the new "Sharing Sessions" can be effective in making this point.

TELEPHONE LISTING

47. Has the possibility of a "universal" telephone number listing — identical in telephone directories throughout the U.S. and Canada — been considered?

G.S.O. will study the matter.

48. What is the sense of the Conference on: (1) A Delegate who might ask for a fee, in addition to expenses, for speaking at an Area A.A. Conference, (2) The payment of such a fee?

It was the sense of the Conference that A.A. members should not receive fees for A.A. talks.

49. Can G.S.O. mail to each group, once or twice a year, copies of the pamphlet: "What Happens When You Put \$3.00 in the Hat?"

Copies of the pamphlet are available from G.S.O. It was suggested mailings to groups be handled by the Areas.

50. What is the reason for the discrepancy between the membership figures of 310,000 shown in one report and the 190,348 shown in another report.

It was explained that the smaller figure refers to the number of active members reported by the groups. The larger figure is an estimate that includes an allowance for "unreported" or "inactive" membership, based on formulas applied to recent censuses of the membership.

Working With Others

The 1962 General Service Conference had recommended that Delegates establish lines of communication to directors of outside agencies concerned with the problem of alcoholism. It had been emphasized that such contacts should be made within the framework of the Traditional A.A. principle of "cooperation but not affiliation."

The 1963 Conference session on "cooperation" indicated that some progress has been made — although much more remains to be done — in this field.

A number of Delegates reported that they, or members of their Area Committees had established contacts with key people in outside agencies, explaining the scope and limitations of the A.A. recovery program, and offering A.A. cooperation, upon request.

Allan B., Trustee of the General Service Board and Chairman of its Public Information Committee, reported that P.I.C. has continued its program of establishing better liaison with other Agencies, as approved by previous Conferences. He said it appeared that there is now far better understanding of A.A. by these agencies, (and of what the Fellowship can and cannot do), than was the case three years ago.

Third Legacy Procedures

More than 25 Delegates participated actively in a lively discussion on the possible need to consider modifying Third Legacy procedures recommended for elections of Conference Delegates and Area Committee Members.

The current Third Legacy Manual urges that Conference personnel be elected by a two-thirds majority or, if it does not appear that this method will work, that a winner be picked "out of the hat" from among leading (and available) candidates. It has always been stressed that Third Legacy recommendations are not binding on the Fellowship and that they are suggested only, as a means of minimizing "politics" in A.A.

Special Grant

It was the unanimous sense of the meeting that the 1963 Conference approved the action of the General Service Board of Trustees in making a special monthly cash grant to Ebby T., the man who helped co-founder Bill W. achieve sobriety and who was indirectly responsible for creation of the A.A. Fellowship. Ebby has been ill and in serious financial straits for some time. In a stirring tribute to Ebby as "one to whom we all owe our lives," Bill pointed out that the assistance to Ebby could "emphatically" not come out of group contributions and that the present grant was from publishing proceeds.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A. A. Grapevine, Inc.

DECEMBER 31, 1962

	December 31, 1962		December 31, 1961	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$144,885	\$ 42,537	\$148,296	\$ 28,035
Accounts Receivable	7,446	2,189	6,597	2,267
Inventories	69,400	1,551	51,700	2,353
Prepaid Expenses	5,223	6,776	8,816	7,217
Furniture and Equipment (net)	1	3,326	1	3,535
RESERVE FUND and CONVENTION GUARANTEE FUNDS	259,426		218,896	
Total Assets	<u>486,381</u>	<u>56,379</u>	<u>434,306</u>	<u>43,407</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	22,840	5,964	14,356	5,361
Unearned Income	619	59,894	619	52,356
Due General Service Board		11,570		11,570
Total Liabilities	<u>23,459</u>	<u>77,428</u>	<u>14,975</u>	<u>69,287</u>
NET WORTH				
Accumulated Income (Deficit)				
Balance, January 1	200,435	(25,881)	191,727	(33,876)
Income for Year (Exhibit B)	9,561	4,831	8,708	7,995
Transfer to CONVENTION FUND	(6,500)			
Capital Stock		1		1
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUNDS	259,426		218,896	
Total Net Worth	<u>462,922</u>	<u>(21,049)</u>	<u>419,331</u>	<u>(25,880)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office	\$ 10,815		\$ 10,798	
Publishing (Note A)	124,436		132,811	
General Fund (Note A)	68,245		56,826	
Reserve and Convention Funds	259,426		218,896	
Total — as above	<u>462,922</u>		<u>419,331</u>	
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUNDS				
	Reserve	Convention	Reserve	
Cash	\$ 5,975	\$ 7,514	\$ 8,862	
U.S. Treasury Obligations	228,477		198,688	
Corporate Bonds — U.S.	9,356		9,356	
Mortgage Debentures — Can.		6,000		
Accrued Interest	2,104		1,990	
Totals — at Cost	<u>245,912</u>	<u>13,514</u>	<u>218,896</u>	

NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS — In the attached statements the accounts of The A. A. Grapevine, Inc. are presented in one column, while the other column, under the heading of "Service Office", combines the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of the General Service Board are further subdivided into four Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CONVENTION GUARANTEE FUND, which was established in 1962 to underwrite a possible deficit in receipts from International Convention to be held in Toronto in 1965. To the extent it is not so used it is to be refunded to the subscribers.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, the costs of the General Service Conference.

COMBINED INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Board and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1962

	Year 1962		Year 1961	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
INCOME				
Sales and subscriptions	\$263,870	\$148,313	\$232,345	\$136,877
LESS: Cost of Products Sold	81,352	35,074	79,539	34,230
Royalties on Books	26,506		24,181	
Gross Profit from Sales	156,012	113,239	128,625	102,647
Contributions	256,015		238,946	
Total Income	412,027	113,239	367,571	102,647
EXPENSES				
Salaries	181,054	60,142	157,457	51,693
Rent	30,089	10,470	29,716	10,333
Service Office Printing	33,258		39,466	
Shipping and Mailing	27,865	13,483	21,744	11,429
Other Office Expenses	37,652	12,311	29,124	10,269
Insurance and Taxes	14,760	5,747	11,360	4,278
Professional Services, Gifts	13,374	1,900	15,456	2,200
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	7,444	575	5,816	484
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	12,293		13,956	
P.I.C., Promotion, Travel	5,455	3,584	3,162	3,773
General Service Conference	31,815	196	30,354	193
Foreign Literature	4,510			
Film Strip and Convention Film	2,897		1,252	
Total Expense	402,466	108,408	358,863	94,652
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) (Exhibit A)	9,561	4,831	8,708	7,995
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office	(\$15,983)		(\$13,715)	
Publishing	56,625		43,812	
General Fund (before dividends from Publishing)	(31,081)		(21,389)	
Total - as above	9,561		8,708	
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUND CHANGES	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Reserve</u>	
Balance, January 1	\$218,896		\$194,974	
Book Discounts Donated	18,706		16,665	
Subscriptions		\$13,485		
Investment Income (net)	8,310	29	7,257	
Balance, December 31	245,912	13,514	218,896	

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, of the Convention Guarantee Fund as Convention Fund, and of the Reserve Fund and General Fund by those names.

NOTE A - After dividends of \$65,000 in 1962 and \$55,000 in 1961 paid by Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B - Advances of \$16,000 in 1962 and \$13,000 in 1961 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years. Advances to the Group Contribution Fund in these and prior years remaining unpaid at December 31, 1962 totaled \$82,765.

NOTE C - The Convention Fund includes cash of \$6,513 in U.S. currency and the balance of assets are in Canadian currency, stated at par in these statements.

1962 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS TO GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE FUND

	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	52	31	60	\$ 1,756.00	973	\$ 1.80
Alaska	24	18	75	664.60	265	2.83
Arizona	70	42	60	2,556.75	952	2.69
Arkansas	50	34	68	1,460.25	706	2.07
California	945	538	57	40,507.06	20,949	1.93
Colorado	58	43	74	4,042.86	1,248	3.24
Connecticut	101	60	59	4,136.50	2,038	2.03
Delaware	15	14	93	916.00	289	3.17
D.C.	27	20	74	1,566.88	776	2.02
Florida	216	137	63	8,358.88	3,775	2.21
Georgia	86	58	67	2,618.60	1,355	1.93
Hawaii	28	12	43	1,371.50	316	4.34
Idaho	26	17	66	778.53	355	2.19
Illinois	430	277	64	7,142.78	8,650	.83
Indiana	162	77	48	3,582.00	2,135	1.68
Iowa	78	46	59	4,039.91	1,575	2.57
Kansas	81	51	63	2,701.57	1,365	1.98
Kentucky	84	50	60	3,495.99	900	3.88
Louisiana	93	45	48	2,598.00	1,600	1.62
Maine	46	32	70	1,306.75	470	2.78
Maryland	95	65	68	3,201.76	1,426	2.24
Massachusetts	169	105	62	6,185.50	3,375	1.83
Michigan	311	158	51	9,873.02	5,200	1.90
Minnesota	238	172	72	6,573.33	4,344	1.51
Mississippi	29	23	79	1,236.50	642	1.93
Missouri	144	71	49	3,321.55	2,360	1.41
Montana	52	26	50	970.19	540	1.80
Nebraska	52	41	79	1,876.00	590	3.18
Nevada	31	29	94	1,440.65	600	2.40
New Hampshire	24	11	46	765.00	320	2.39
New Jersey	204	109	63	6,173.78	2,914	2.12
New Mexico	49	24	49	1,178.12	650	1.81
New York	439	300	68	23,274.93	8,725	2.67
North Carolina	143	79	55	3,744.05	2,220	1.70
North Dakota	36	26	72	1,264.00	500	2.53
Ohio	409	204	50	10,883.51	8,100	1.34
Oklahoma	72	59	82	4,594.67	1,420	3.24
Oregon	89	58	65	2,258.65	1,010	2.24
Pennsylvania	263	172	65	9,142.87	4,345	2.10
Rhode Island	20	9	45	662.00	235	2.82
South Carolina	60	39	65	1,781.80	900	1.98
South Dakota	51	26	51	1,229.14	735	1.67
Tennessee	56	31	55	1,734.56	790	2.20
Texas	302	169	56	11,505.81	6,636	1.73
Utah	48	30	63	874.00	750	1.17
Vermont	30	16	53	656.00	336	1.95
Virginia	107	66	62	5,889.27	2,138	2.75
Washington	147	102	69	5,262.52	2,224	2.37
West Virginia	45	18	40	1,033.00	570	1.81
Wisconsin	158	92	58	3,612.65	2,039	1.77
Wyoming	23	13	57	513.50	227	2.26
Puerto Rico	18	12	67	631.75	400	1.58
TOTAL for U.S.	6,586	3,957	60%	\$228,945.49	117,953	\$1.94

PROVINCE	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alberta	102	52	51	2,425.89	981	2.47
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	28	16	57	574.68	506	1.14
Newfoundland	12	4	33	172.90	118	1.47
Nova Scotia	52	27	52	847.01	600	1.41
Prince Edward Island	10	5	50	414.75	184	2.25
British Columbia	148	89	60	4,797.93	1,954	2.46
Manitoba	48	32	67	2,023.31	918	2.20
N.W. Territories	3	3	100	37.20	13	2.86
Ontario	307	191	63	7,689.08	4,317	1.78
Quebec	180	78	43	2,175.41	2,605	.84
Saskatchewan	54	20	37	1,471.05	874	1.68
Yukon Territory	2	2	100	40.00	23	1.74
TOTAL for CANADA	946	519	55%	\$22,669.21	13,093	\$1.73
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	7,532	4,476	60%	\$251,614.70	131,046	\$1.92
FOREIGN						
Foreign	1,484			\$2,691.18	25,377	
Lone Members*				—	646	
World Hello				70.80		
Internationalists				673.14	265	
International Doctors				100.00		
Hospital Groups	476			472.00	10,602	
Prison Groups	564			229.97	22,412	
GRAND TOTAL	10,056			\$255,851.79	190,348	

*Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1961-62

	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
U.S.A. 1962	6,586	3,957	60	\$228,945.49	117,953	\$1.94
U.S.A. 1961	6,208	3,900	63	210,962.88	109,923	1.92
Increase (Decrease)	378	57	(3%)	\$ 17,982.61	8,030	\$.02
Canada 1962	946	519	55	\$ 22,669.21	13,093	\$1.73
Canada 1961	876	534	61	23,903.10	12,554	\$1.90
Increase (Decrease)	70	(15)	(6%)	(\$ 1,233.89)	539	\$(.17)
U.S.A. & Canada	7,532	4,476	60	\$251,614.70	131,046	\$1.92
U.S.A. & Canada	7,084	4,434	63	234,865.98	122,477	1.92
Increase (Decrease)	448	42	(3%)	\$ 16,748.72	8,569	\$ -0-

TRUSTEES

The committee recommends the adoption of the report of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board and accepts the following nominees as Trustees and Officers of the General Service Board:

CLASS A TRUSTEES

Leonard V. Harrison
Austin H. MacCormick
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
Harrison M. Trice
L. Ivan Underwood
Dr. Harvey Cruickshank
Judge John M. Murtagh

CLASS B TRUSTEES

Allen B.
David B.
Mary B.
Don G.
Thomas A. S.
Eugene K.
Howard B.
Jim M.
Roy S.

OFFICERS

Chairman - Dr. John L. Norris
1st Vice-Chairman - Bernard B. Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman - Allan B.
Secretary - Eugene K.
Treasurer - Archibald B. Roosevelt

The Committee expresses their thanks to the Regions involved for their cooperation in following, for the first time, the procedure approved by the 1962 General Service Conference for the nomination of Class B Regional Trustees in the United States.

The Committee recommends, in view of the success of the elections held on Friday, April 26, that the procedure be followed for future elections of Class B Regional Trustees in the United States.

ADMISSIONS

Following approval by the 1962 General Service Conference, the Delegate from the Province of Quebec presented a complete statistical report and map supporting the Province's request for an additional Delegate to serve French-speaking groups.

The Committee recommends that an additional Delegate be approved, and that the Delegate be admitted at the 1964 General Service Conference.

The Committee studied the request that a representative of the Young People in A.A. be permitted to attend the General Service Conference as an Observer. It was the feeling of the Committee that all A.A.'s in the United States and Canada are being served adequately under the existing procedure.

The Committee reviewed the problem in the Chicago Area in which two Delegates were elected to serve. In a mail poll prior to the Conference, and at the present meeting, the Committee expressed its conviction that no Delegate should be seated until the Chicago Area agrees locally on a single Delegate. However, the people involved had been invited to meet with the 1963 General Service Conference Admissions Committee at the annual meeting at their own expense.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee met and selected a Chairman from Panel 12.

The Committee noted that a one-page agenda of the General Service Conference activities will be added to the 1963 Final Conference Report.

As is customary, members of the Committee will have an opportunity to review a draft of the Final Report and suggest any changes or corrections that may be necessary. Comments will be sent to the Conference Secretary postmarked no later than May 8, 1963.

OUTSIDE AGENCIES

The Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies recommends:

1. Approval of the following Question and Answers on Retreats for addition to "Cooperation But Not Affiliation":

Q. What is the relationship of A.A. to retreats or other meetings for alcoholics held under the auspices, or in connection with the activities, of religious denominations?

A. There is no formal relationship. Movement-wide experience might be summarized as follows:

1. Traditionally, A.A. does not sponsor such gatherings. There is no such thing as an "A.A. retreat" any more than there is an "A.A. hospital" or an "A.A. clinic." Members participate in such activities as individuals.
2. Since the Fellowship does not affiliate with other organizations, the A.A. name cannot properly be used to identify or publicize retreats or activities sponsored by others. This applies even when most of the participants (perhaps all of them) consider themselves members of A.A. The objective is to minimize public misunderstanding of A.A.'s purpose and function.
3. If reference to the participation of A.A. members seems unavoidable in advance notices or in reports, such reference should also emphasize that A.A. as a movement, does not sponsor retreats or religious activities and members attend as *individuals*.

2. Reaffirmation of action:

- a. That a member of P.I.C. represent the Board of Trustees at the annual meeting of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.
- b. That ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside of A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.
- c. That the Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with Directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their respective Areas. Addresses are available from G.S.O.

FINANCE

(G. S. B. and G. S. C. Committees)

Meeting in a joint session, the two Finance Committees:

1. Agreed to reconvene November 1 and 2, 1963, subject to the approval of the Chairman of the General Service Board, in accordance with the proposal of the 1963 Conference. The meeting will be for the purpose of examining suggestions and recommendations received from Delegates with reference to plans to make G.S.O. self-supporting.
2. Accepted the report of the Treasurer of the General Service Board.
3. Agreed that the combined Committee "looks with favor on increased participation by overseas A.A. units in the General Service Conference and recommends that a study of factors involved be made by the G.S.O. staff."
4. Recommended that any records of contributions received by G.S.O. in Canadian dollars be clarified with footnote which would indicate that there is a difference in the exchange rate, so that the reader will understand that contributions in Canadian dollars are larger than the amount shown.

LITERATURE

The Conference Literature Committee recommends that:

1. A.A.W.S. continue to make available translated literature as needed.
2. Concurred with the action of the Board Literature Committee re a concordance to the Big Book — noting one minority vote which requested a review of costs.
3. "Partners," when revised be retitled "The Group Handbook" with subtitle, "How the A.A. Group Starts and Grows."
4. The need for a study guide to the Steps and Traditions or condensed 12 Step book be explored, and a report brought back to the 1964 Conference.

The joint meeting of the Conference Literature Committee and the Board's Literature Committee recommend that:

1. The pamphlet "Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A." be discontinued and a new pamphlet be created outlining specific information about the formation and function of groups in institutions, including material pertaining to county jails, orientation programs, training programs for the young, open door groups, women's groups, etc. One page of Warden's comments is considered to be sufficient. The draft of the pamphlet to be reviewed by interested penologists as well as the Conference Literature Committee. The Committee further requested that information for the pamphlet be sought from Delegates and Institution Committees.
2. A revised pamphlet on the relationship of A.A. and tranquilizers and sedatives be prepared, such pamphlet to emphasize that it is written by non-experts and the importance to A.A. of maintaining its amateur standing. It was felt that A.A. has a responsibility to share its information with alcoholics but that we should do this in a way which will not antagonize the medical profession, and that we emphasize that our concern is with the unsupervised use of pills (medication). It was further suggested that the last page of the pamphlet as presently written be placed first; that more varied opinions of more doctors be included, and that the draft be submitted to the directors of N.A.A.A.P. as well as Conference Literature Committee for suggestions.
3. Pending this review, the present pamphlet continue to be used in order to share A.A. experience.

GRAPEVINE

Advisory action suggested for Conference:

1. To reaffirm that all retiring Delegates will act as Grapevine Representatives and notice of this be placed in the Grapevine and the General Service Office Bulletin.
2. All Delegates should help select the Grapevine Representative in every group in their area.
3. All G.S.O. pamphlets be scrutinized for mention, wherever possible, of the Grapevine as a recovery tool of A.A.
4. Continuing review of the plans of the Grapevine to be published in Spanish and other languages.
5. Committee reviewed with the Staff and Trustee members of the Corporate Board of the Grapevine the activities of the past year and expressed its approval and support.

It is our pleasure to report that George F. of West Virginia will be the 1964 Chairman of the Grapevine Conference Committee.

We wish to thank all here present for the cooperation that we have received and hope that this Committee will always keep in touch.

POLICY

The Policy Committee

1. Wishes to go on record as thanking the Tape Committee for their work in preparing and providing tapes of A.A. talks to groups at low cost.
2. Affirms the resolution to supply "Sharing Sessions" information to the Delegates in order that Sharing Sessions can be carried on in all areas.
3. Recommends that G.S.O. continue to refer local matters back to the Area involved with suggestion that they contact the local Delegate, and that copies of all correspondence referring to such local matters be sent to the Delegate.
4. Recommends that notices of newly listed and delisted groups be sent only to the Areas concerned. This is in the interest of reducing mailing costs.
5. Recommends that G.S.O. provide a suggested standard letterhead style for those areas desiring to print their own stationery.
6. Recommends that notices be sent with the "Exchange Bulletin" clarifying that Bulletins are for the use of the groups and not exclusively for group secretaries or G.S.R.'s.
7. The Policy Committee is in agreement with the current and proposed editorial and subscription practices of the Grapevine and recommends they be continued.
8. Recommends that wherever the words "Alternate Delegate" appear in the text of the Third Legacy Manual, the phrase be changed to read "Alternate or Assistant Delegate."
9. Reaffirms that G.S.O. continue its current policy of co-operation but not affiliation with Al-Anon.
10. Recommends a joint meeting of the G.S.B. and Conference Finance Committee be held in October or November. Also that this be extended to other Committees as deemed necessary.

AGENDA

The Committee requests:

1. Subjects should be submitted to Agenda Committee throughout the year as they come up — suggest July and October Policy Committees also review Conference discussion subjects.
2. If any vital or more important agenda subject comes to the attention of A.A.W.S. after approval of tentative agenda in October, it is requested that it, as well as indication of which previously approved subject is to be eliminated, if any, be brought to attention of Agenda Committee for reaction prior to G.S.B.'s final determination.
3. Let Agenda Committee suggest specific subjects before finalizing the agenda.
4. Suggest Agenda Committee members keep one another informed of correspondence through use of carbons.
5. Offer to succeeding committee, any items not included in current agenda.
6. Suggest G.S.O. review throughout coming year appropriate expression of gratitude to Bill and Lois — for presentation to 1964 Conference.
7. Area Highlights be continued around a central theme.

The Committee expressed its appreciation of the dedicated effort made by Beth K. and Herb M. and all others involved in the preparation of 1963 Conference.

1965 CONVENTION ADVISORY COMMITTEE

The Committee endorsed and recommends approval of the following statement of policies and procedures for the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A. at Toronto, Ontario, Canada July 2-4, 1965, as submitted by the chairman of A.A. World Services, Inc.:

GENERAL POLICY

In accordance with approved procedures, Convention plans will be in the hands of the following committees:

1. **1965 Convention Committee of the General Service Board** comprises the Chairman of General Services, the Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board, and the Staff Member serving as Conference Secretary. This committee is responsible to the Board of Trustees and works closely with the Convention Advisory Committee and the Convention Host Committee. It has the responsibility of programming, meeting facilities, housing and feeding, registration, public relations, sale of literature, decorations and signs, and all arrangements with the Convention Bureau.
2. **The Convention Advisory Committee** comprises the Chairman, all current and past Ontario Delegates, current Delegates from other Canadian provinces, fifteen U.S. Delegates. This committee serves in an advisory capacity on matters of policy referred to it by the Convention Committee. The Canadian Delegates on the Advisory Committee have been responsible for the securing of the Guarantee Fund. Current Canadian Delegates of all provinces will be responsible for Advance Registration.
3. **The Convention Host Committee** is a local committee. It may have as many subcommittees as deemed necessary and is responsible to the Chairman of the Convention Committee. The co-Chairman of the Host Committee will coordinate Al-Anon Convention activities. Current subcommittees of the Host Committee are as follows:

a. Courtesy Car Fleet Committee	h. Interpreters Committee
b. Decorating Committee	i. Nursery Committee
c. Entertainment Committee	j. Registration Committee
d. First Aid Committee	k. Special Events Committee
e. Housing Committee	l. Transportation Committee
f. Greeters Committee	m. Visitation Committee
g. Information Booth Committee	

All plans concerning expenditures by the Advisory and Host Committees are to be cleared beforehand with the Chairman of the Convention Committee.

The 1965 Convention Committee of the General Service Board has the following officers:

- As Chairman — Herb Morse,
(Chairman, G.S.O. General Services)
- As Public Relations Chairman — Allan Bachman,
(Chairman, Trustees' Public Information Committee)
- As Convention Secretary — Beth Kuhlmann,
(G.S.O. Staff Secretary assigned to Conference)

The Convention Advisory Committee

Chairman — Whit Hillmer Treasurer — Tom Turner
Vice Chairman — Allen Boyle Secretary — Russ Moffit

The other members of the Advisory Committee at this time are shown on the attached list. Three U.S. Delegates will be added each year at the 1963, '64 and '65 Conferences. Newly elected Delegates will replace retiring ones from Canadian provinces other than Ontario.

The Host Committee. At a meeting of the Advisory Committee held on December 8, 1962, the following officers were elected:
Chairman — Jim Lumley Co-Chairman — Edythe Dolan

FINANCING

An amount in excess of \$6,500 has been collected in Canada for the Guarantee Fund; \$6,000 debentures were purchased from the Canada Permanent Mortgage Corporation, and set aside in a custody account (with first purchase of debentures earning 4 1/2%). Interest rates fluctuate and the last purchase made was at 5 1/4%.

Upon authorization by the General Service Board, \$6,500 from the General Fund has been placed in a thrift account at the Chase Manhattan Bank in New York City, representing the General Service Board's share of the 1965 Convention Guarantee Fund. No withdrawals are permitted on either one of these accounts until July, 1965. Accumulative interest earned by the money in the Guarantee Fund will be turned over to the General Service Board of A.A. and the monies returned to the owners if there is no deficit.

If deficit occurs, amount necessary to meet loss will be prorated on a dollar basis against the Guarantee Fund, as the General Service Board will share in any loss. Interest earned by the \$6,500 underwritten by the General Service Board and that earned by the Canadian deposits will be applied equally against the loss, if any. A cutoff date in Canada for contributions to the Guarantee Fund was set at July 31, 1963.

Preliminary Convention expenses to date are being advanced by A.A.W.S., Inc., and by the Ontario General Service Committee. The Chairman of the Convention will be kept informed on all expenses incurred.

REGISTRATION FEE

A tentative registration fee of \$5.00 was set to cover meetings and panel discussions only. There may be an extra charge for entertainment and these arrangements will be handled by the chairman of the local Host Committee.

ADVANCE REGISTRATION

Advance registration will open March 1, 1964 and carry through November 15, 1964, in Canada only. General registration will open on January 15, 1965.

CONVENTION FACILITIES

Headquarters for the A.A. Convention will be the Royal York Hotel. The King Edward Sheraton Hotel will be the headquarters for the Al-Anon portion of the Convention. Manager of the Convention Bureau is Mr. John Moore.

An offer will be made to lease the facilities of the Maple Leaf Gardens for the large meetings to be held Friday and Saturday evenings and Sunday morning. The Gardens has a capacity of 13,000 including 2,000 on floor surface. A tentative hold has been made for three days at a rental of \$1,500 per day, but it is hoped that a lower lease figure can be negotiated.

Toronto Convention Bureau will handle all housing and registration at no charge — but will not handle money. The Chairman of the Convention Committee and the G.S.O. Accounting Supervisor will meet with the Bureau in 1963.

PUBLICITY

It was felt that the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A. be publicized only in the "Group Exchange Bulletin" and the "Grapevine" during 1963.

FUTURE MEETINGS

The Host Committee and subcommittees will have organization meetings in the first six months of 1963. No meeting of the Advisory Committee is required until the fall of 1963.

1963 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(13) <i>Josephine Dix</i> , 113 S. Conception St., Mobile	MICHIGAN	(13) S.E. — <i>Edith Myers</i> , 23553 W. Seven Mile Road, Detroit 19
ALASKA	(13) (Vic) <i>V.E., Kelly</i> , Box 1417, Anchorage		(13) Central — <i>Fred E. Scott</i> , 3409 Cedar St., Midland
ARIZONA	(12) <i>Bennie H. Grove</i> , 5001 W. Mackenzie		(12) Western — <i>Austin Doyle</i> , 503 Park Bldg. 132 West South St., Kalamazoo
ARKANSAS	(13) <i>Mooring Hill</i> , Cotton Plant	MINNESOTA	(12) Northern — <i>Mrs. Donna Thomson</i> , South Lake Irving, Bemidji
CALIFORNIA	(13) So. Calif. — <i>Clyde Davis</i> , 126 So. Mansfield Ave., Los Angeles 36 Dr., Phoenix 31		(13) Southern — <i>G.J. Ward</i> , 150 West 4th St., St. Paul 2
	(13) No. Coastal — <i>Bill Garrison</i> , 1723 39th Avenue, San Francisco 22	MISSISSIPPI	(12) <i>John Evans</i> , P.O. Box 987, Vicksburg
	(12) No. Interior — <i>Cliff Johnson</i> , 616 23rd St., Apt. 1, Sacramento	MISSOURI	(13) Eastern — <i>Al H. Sanning</i> , Route #3, Jefferson City
	(12) San Diego — <i>Fritz Heinig</i> , 3270 Bay-side Lane, San Diego 8		(13) Western — <i>Ken Sperry</i> , 432 West 35th St., Kansas City
	(12) Southern Coastal — <i>Joe Balder</i> , 2230 Nelson Ave., Redondo Beach	MONTANA	(12) <i>Ed Gendle</i> , Montana State Hosp., I.T. Dept., Warm Springs
COLORADO	(13) <i>Floyd Pleasant</i> , Box 246, Craig	NEBRASKA	(12) <i>Robert Maxey</i> , Box 346, Superior
CONNECTICUT	(13) <i>Frank Jackman</i> , 32 Morris Ave., Bristol	NEVADA	(13) <i>Kathryn Appelt</i> , 1603 Hastings Ave., Las Vegas
DELAWARE	(12) <i>Loyal Larson</i> , 18 Atkins Avenue, Colonial Park, Wilmington 5	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(12) <i>Glenn Smith</i> , 238 Marcy, Portsmouth
D.C.	(13) <i>C.W. Doyle</i> , 5128 10th Rd. N., Arlington, Virginia	NEW JERSEY	(13) Northern — <i>William H. Lyon</i> , P.O. Box 305, Belmar
FLORIDA	(13) Northern — <i>Hartwell Randall</i> , 281 White Street, Daytona Beach		(12) Southern — <i>Harry Kidd</i> , 151A Wallworth Apts. Haddonfield
	(13) Southern — <i>Robert G. Ryder</i> , 3500 S. County Road, Palm Beach	NEW MEXICO	(12) <i>Ken Onstott</i> , P.O. Box 154, Farmington
GEORGIA	(12) <i>Gene Coker</i> , 1519 Stratford Circle, Macon	NEW YORK	(13) Central — <i>Mrs. Jane Kenny</i> , 29 Lilac Drive, Apt. 1, Rochester 20
HAWAII	(13) <i>Ben Stoddard</i> , 53-103 Kamehameha Highway, Punaluu, Oahu		(12) Mohawk-Hudson — <i>Ivar Johnson</i> , 1467 Van Antwerp Rd., Schenectady
IDAHO	(12) <i>Charles Helfrich</i> , 1223 Holly, Nampa		(13) Southeastern — <i>Ralph Abringer</i> , 39 Washington Ave. Glen Head, L.I.
ILLINOIS	(13) Downstate — <i>Edwin Craig</i> , 1408 Holly Hill Drive, Champaign	NORTH CAROLINA	(12) Western — <i>Maynard Ayers</i> , 16 Lunn Court, Wellsville
	(12) Downstate — <i>Carl Stutsman</i> , 3508 30th St., Rock Island		(13) <i>Mack Franks</i> , Franklin
INDIANA	(13) <i>Bill Goen</i> , Box 42, Salem	NORTH DAKOTA	(12) <i>Orville Larson</i> , 830. 3rd St., S.W. Minot
IOWA	(13) <i>Ralph Canty</i> , 406 North Maple Ave., New Hampton	OHIO	(13) Central & S.E. — <i>Ivan M. Roberts</i> , 263 Bachmann Ave. Newark
KANSAS	(12) <i>Paul Moon</i> , 1440 Utah, Hoxie		(13) N.E. — <i>George Mills</i> , 1057 Sylvan Ave., Lakewood 7
KENTUCKY	(12) <i>Robert Prewitt</i> , 798 Sherwood Dr., Lexington		(12) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Mich. — <i>Roy DaVoll</i> , 2470 Broadway Toledo 9
LOUISIANA	(13) <i>Mrs. Hope E. Schulze</i> , 1801 Short St., New Orleans	OKLAHOMA	(12) S.W. — <i>Harold Rice</i> , 51 Ironwood Drive, W. Carrollton
MAINE	(12) <i>Richard Scotten</i> , 17 Oceanhouse Rd., Cape Elizabeth		(13) <i>Lawrence Ferguson</i> , 2150 South Cincinnati, Tulsa
MARYLAND	(12) <i>John Vollmer</i> , 1001 Walnut Ave., Baltimore 29	OREGON	(12) <i>Bruce Williamson</i> , 3004, N.E. Weidler, Portland
MASSACHUSETTS	(13) Eastern — <i>George C. McAllister</i> , 517 Washington St., Brighton 35	PENNSYLVANIA	(13) Eastern — <i>Paul Orandosb</i> , 110 S. Hanover St., Pottstown
	(12) Western — <i>Clarence Hadley</i> , 896 Stonehill Rd., Wilbraham		(13) Western — <i>J. Glenn Weaver</i> , 410 Eagle Point Blvd., Erie
		RHODE ISLAND	(12) <i>Irving Fraser</i> , 138 Benefit St., Providence 3

1963 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	CANADA	
SOUTH CAROLINA	(12) <i>Manuel Berger</i> , 3411 Two Notch Rd., Lot #4, Columbia	PROVINCE	PANEL
SOUTH DAKOTA	*(12) <i>Jake Steinberg</i> , Box 447, Yankton	ALBERTA	(12) <i>Don Nicholson</i> , P.O. Box 1088, R.C.A.F. Station, Cold Lake
TENNESSEE	(12) <i>Dennis Mahoney</i> , 318 Walnut St., Apt. 36 Chattanooga	ATLANTIC PROVINCES	(12) <i>Jack Milligan</i> , 1055 Gottingen St., Halifax, N.S.
TEXAS	(13) N.E. — <i>Emory E. Richardson</i> , 3112 Rotan Lane, Dallas 29	BRITISH COLUMBIA-YUKON	(13) <i>Jim Waller</i> , 225 St. Lawrence St., Victoria, B.C.
	(12) N.W. — <i>Tom Hutchinson</i> , 3413 43rd St., Lubbock	MANITOBA	(12) (W.A.) <i>Bill Campbell</i> , 1½ Maple Leaf Apts., 915 Corydon Ave., Winnipeg 9
	(13) S.E. — <i>Ruby Black</i> , 319 3rd Ave. North, Texas City	ONTARIO	(13) Eastern — <i>Harold Frederick</i> , 131 Alfred St., Kingston, Ontario
	(12) S.W. — <i>Marguerite Costello</i> , 1908-A West 33rd St., Austin		(12) Western — <i>Charles Chalklin</i> , 870 Guelph St., Apt. 2, Kitchener
UTAH	(13) <i>Bill Coldeway</i> , 4077 West 4990 South, Kearns 18		(13) Northern — <i>John B. King</i> , Suite 308, 731 Pine St, Sault Ste, Marie
VERMONT	(12) <i>Ed Devino</i> , 15 Lapointe St., Winooski	QUEBEC	(12) <i>Roland Davidson</i> , 3462 Shuter St., Penthouse, Montreal
VIRGINIA	(13) <i>Francis Lineweaver</i> , P.O. Box 809, Staunton	SASKATCHEWAN	(12) <i>Mac Cheater</i> , 1510 Ewart Ave., Saskatoon
WASHINGTON	(13) <i>Everett A. Kronlund</i> , 6327 16th N.E., Seattle 15	OBSERVERS	
WEST VIRGINIA	(13) <i>George H. Francis</i> , Box 5216, Charleston	FINLAND	<i>Aarne Helin</i> , Kapteeninkata 12 Al, Helsinki
WISCONSIN	(12) N. Wisc. & Upper Mich. — <i>Bill Collins</i> , 2012 Jackson St., Ishpeming	FRANCE	<i>Nichols Hall</i> , 25 East End Ave., New York 28, N.Y.
	(13) Southern — <i>Douglas J. McClelland</i> , Suite 908, 735 Water St., Milwaukee	HOLLAND	<i>Adrian Frylink</i> , Box 339, Babylon, New York
WYOMING	*(12) <i>Mauritz Kallerud</i> , 1516 W. 12th St., Casper	INTERNATIONALIST	<i>Captain Jack Sloggett</i> , 9 Glen Ave., Cape Elizabeth, Maine
PUERTO RICO	(12) <i>Francisco Navarro</i> , Box 103, Cayey	NORWAY	<i>Hart Sonju</i> , 1117 East Earl St., Philadelphia 25 Pennsylvania
	*Alternate Delegate	SWEDEN	<i>Ralph Bugli</i> , Bedford Village, New York

ROSTER

1963 CONFERENCE MEMBERS

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Rochester, New York

Mr. Leonard V. Harrison
Box 383
Old Lyme, Connecticut

Mr. Austin H. MacCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30 Street
New York 16, New York

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt
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200 East 66th Street
New York 21, New York

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(Vice Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York 22, New York

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215 Milbank Avenue
Greenwich, Connecticut

Prof. Harrison M. Trice
School of Industrial Labor Relations
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Dennis Manders
Marie Proctor
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A.A. GRAPEVINE

Mary Montague
Jack Morley
4 Observers from
the Grapevine
Editorial Board

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

April 1963

Nonalcoholic Trustees (Class A)

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. ... is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Works in Rochester, N.Y. ... Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism... President of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

LEONARD V. HARRISON... first came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as Chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become a Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board.

ARCHIBALD B. ROOSEVELT (Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Board's Finance and Budgetary Committee)... was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs.

BERNARD B. SMITH... was elected to the General Service Board in June, 1944 and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth, on her visit to the United States.

HARRY M. TIEBOUT, M.D. ... was elected to the Board in April, 1957. He was the first psychiatrist to recognize the work of Alcoholics Anonymous and to use A.A. principles in his own practice. In the early days when A.A. was little known, he was instrumental in having Bill W. speak before the Neurology and Psychiatry section of the Medical Society of the State of New York, and the American Psychiatric Association. He has written many inspiring articles, among them, "The Ego Factors in the Surrender of Alcoholism."

HARRISON M. TRICE, Ph.D. ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1957 and has served there, and as a member of the Literature Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is a Professor in the School of Industrial and Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

L. IVAN UNDERWOOD... was elected to the Board in January, 1955. He heads up the export activities of Republic Steel Corporation, traveling a great deal and visiting A.A. overseas. He was Chairman of the General Service Board Literature Committee in 1962 and is presently serving in that capacity.

A.A. Trustees (Class B)

ALLAN BACHMAN... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1960 and has served as Second Vice Chairman of the Board; also, as Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board. He has also served as Chairman of the General Service Conference Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies. He also serves as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He joined A.A. in 1947 and is still an active member of the Stamford, Connecticut Group. He served as President of the New York Intergroup Steering Committee from June, 1956 to July, 1957. Professionally, he serves as Executive Vice President of the National Better Business Bureau and is the author of several books and a number of articles on business subjects for business and trade magazines.

DAVID M. BANCROFT... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. groups in Quebec, Canada. He has had 18 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Delegate to the General Service Conference from the Province of Quebec. He introduced A.A. to Montreal and subsequently to all of the Province of Quebec. He has his own business, a general accounting service.

MARY BERNSON... elected to the Board in January, 1962. She has been an active member of the Chappaqua New York Group since March, 1954. She has served as Secretary, Program and Group Chairman, and has been a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board since March, 1961. Professionally, Mary has been a practicing lawyer in both New York City and Chappaqua since 1948.

SUMNER CAMPBELL... was elected to the General Service Board, serving as Secretary, in April, 1959, having served as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. since May, 1957. He has been active in A.A. in the New York area since December 7, 1945 and served as Treasurer of the A.A. Intergroup Association of New York City for one year. Professionally, he is sales manager for a manufacturer's representative, selling toys and housewares. He will have completed his four-year term as Trustee this April.

B. PATRICK CRONIN... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1959 following nomination by the A.A. groups of Minnesota. He was the first A.A. in Minnesota (in 1940) and started the first A.A. group in the Twin Cities in 1941. During the last two years, he has served as Chairman of the Policy Committee of the General Service Board.

He will have completed his four-year term as Trustee at the April meeting. He has reached the compulsory retirement age of 65 years. He was formerly with the Department of Public Welfare, City of Minneapolis. He served as a Delegate from Southern Minnesota to the General Service Conference in 1951 and 1952.

DON GODDARD... was elected to the General Service Board in October, 1961. He served as Editor of the A.A. Grapevine from 1955 to 1957 and is currently a Director of A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board. He joined A.A. in March, 1953 and is an active member of the Chappaqua, New York Group; also, he is a member of their Steering Committee. Professionally, he was employed as writer-editor for the News Department of the New York World newspaper and published his own weekly paper in Homer, New York for approximately five years. Since that time, he has been writer, editor and commentator for various Radio and Television Networks. He joined A.B.C. News Staff as broadcaster and editor in 1953 and is working there at present. The winner of two Peabody Awards for news presentations, one of these awards was for production of "But for the Grace of God," a televised story of A.A., also "Medical Horizons." He has covered many of the big stories in the last half-dozen years for the network, including participation in two national political conventions.

THOMAS A. SHARPE... was elected to the Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. groups in Florida. He has had 20 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Florida A.A. member. He was also the North Florida Delegate to the General Service Conference in 1951 and 1952. He operates his own business, that of a manufacturer's agent.

G. S. B. TRUSTEE NOMINEES

Non-A.A. Trustee Nominees (Class A)

W. HARVEY CRUICKSHANK, M.D. ... is Vice President and General Manager of the Toronto Area of Bell Telephone Company of Canada. Dr. Cruickshank began his career as a physician; he is a graduate medical doctor, a doctor of psychiatry, and a doctor of public health. After war service, Dr. Cruickshank joined Bell as Medical Director, later became a personnel executive, then Director of Public Relations. He becomes the first nonalcoholic Trustee hailing from Canada.

JOHN M. MURTAGH... is the Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, a new court with 78 judges replacing Magistrates' Courts and Court of Special Sessions. Previously, he had been Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long been a good friend of A.A.

A.A. Trustee Nominee (Class B)

EUGENE S. KELLEY... was elected to the Directorate of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., at their Annual Meeting in April of 1960. He has served on the Finance Committee of the General Service Board for two years. Also serving on the current Study Committee on Salaries and Fringe Benefits.

Has been an active member of the Manhattan Group of New York City since March of 1942. He served as President of New York Intergroup Association Steering Committee from January, 1955 to June, 1956. He has cooperated with the Medical Director of a large corporation in the formation of a policy and plan for the rehabilitation of their alcoholic employees.

In non-A.A. life, he has been employed in industrial sales - with the same company for 42 years.

Growth of Services

In 1945, there were 983 groups in the world and ten employees at G.S.O. were able to provide needed services. That is, one employee for each 98 groups.

Ten years later, A.A. had grown to more than 6000 groups and G.S.O. had 27 employees - or one employee for each 230 groups.

By 1962, the number of groups had passed the 10,000 mark and the equivalent of 35 full-time employees was needed - or one employee for every 286 groups.

In those 17 years G.S.O. services had increased greatly, and the General Service Conference had grown to full stature. But as A.A. and G.S.O. both grew in size, efficiency of services worked to A.A.'s benefit; the G.S.O. employee was able to provide services to three times as many groups as was possible in 1945.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Costs
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1962	10,056	35	286	27.05	167

In the same 17 years, cost of service to a group increased from \$20.60 to \$27.05 - or 34%. While many needed services were added during this period, the cost of providing them actually decreased when judged on the same dollar. Service costs per group increased 34% while the cost of living rose 67% or at twice the rate. (See last two columns of table above for comparative trends in intervening years.)

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilber Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,

Bill

(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

1963 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

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Mac Cheater, Saskatchewan, Canada
Paul Moon, Kansas
Bill Goen, Indiana
Bill Garrison, No. Coastal California
Emory Richardson, N.E. Texas
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